

After-Action Review

Commissioned by the UNDP Crisis Bureau and the UNDP Regional Bureau for Africa



Fully Revised DRAFT (Version 6)

UNDP's Crisis Response in Cabo Delgado (Mozambique)

March - October 2021

Lessons Learned and Recommendations



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Acronyms

AAR	After Action Review
ADIN	North Integrated Development Agency of Mozambique
BERA	Bureau for External Relations and Advocacy
BMS	Bureau for Management Services
BPPS	Bureau for Policy and Programme Support
CAP	Procurement Review Committee
CB	Crisis Bureau
CD	Cabo Delgado
CMST	Crisis Management Support Team
CO	Country Office
CSMT	Country Support Management Team
CTG	“Committed To Good” (Name of a private sector recruitment agency)
DRR	Deputy Resident Representative
DRR-O	Deputy Resident Representative for Operations
EU	European Union
HBDA	Household and Building Damage Assessment
HCT	Humanitarian Country Team
HoET	Head of Engineering Team
HoSO	Head of Sub Office
IDA	Infrastructure Damage Assessment
IED	Improvised Explosive Device
IOM	International Organisation for Migration
IPSA	International Personnel Service Agreement
L1, L2, L3	Crisis Levels 1-3
MRF	Mozambique Recovery Facility
NGO	Non-governmental Organization
NPSA	National Personnel Service Agreement
OCHA	Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs
OM	Operations Manager
POPP	Programme and Operations Policies and Procedures (UNDP Manual)
PRCD	Reconstruction Plan for Cabo Delgado
PREDIM	Resilience and Development Programme for Northern Mozambique
RB	Regional Bureau
RBA	Regional Bureau for Africa
RC	Resident Coordinator
RCO (also: UNRCO)	United Nations Resident Coordinator’s Office
RPBA	Recovery and Peace Building Assessment
RR	Resident Representative
RRT	Rapid Response Team
SADC	South African Development Community
SAMIM	SADC Mission in Mozambique
SEIA	Socio-Economic Impact Assessment
SO	Sub Office
SOP	Standard Operation Procedure
SSAFE	Safe and Secure Approaches in Field Environments (UN Training Course)
TRAC	“Target for Resource Assignment From Core”: UNDP Core Resources

UN OHCHR	United Nations Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights
UNCT	United Nations Country Team
UNHCR	United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees
UNICEF	United Nations Children Fund
UNODC	United Nations Office for Drugs and Crimes
UNV	United Nations Volunteer

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A total of 31 people provided their time and experiences during interviews and discussions, and 42 people were involved in focus group discussions. We are grateful for their inputs.

Finally, the present report could not have been finalized without the critical and competent feedback on draft versions. We are grateful for the commitment of all those colleagues who commented and contributed to preparing UNDP's crisis response system for challenges of the future.

1 Executive Summary

Following the escalation of the crisis in Cabo Delgado province in northern Mozambique towards the end of 2020, UNDP declared a L2 level crisis and deployed a team of first responders to Pemba in March 2021, followed by a second wave of surge deployments from May to October of the same year. A sub office was established in July and stabilization interventions were launched in August 2021. Since the beginning of the response, the CO managed to mobilize \$45 million for stabilization interventions (total received and hard pipeline, as of December 2022). Critical activities have been implemented during the first year of the response, and a scale-up of activities is planned for 2023.

This report summarizes the main findings and lessons learned of the After-Action Review of UNDP's response in the Cabo Delgado, including the surge period from March to October 2021. It proposes a set of recommendations for UNDP at country office and corporate levels. The review was conducted in 4 stages including an inception phase, field work and stakeholder discussions in Maputo and Pemba, additional focus group discussions and stakeholder interviews upon return from Mozambique, as well as a corporate review and vetting phase.

Overall findings

The AAR concludes that “stabilization”, i.e., the combination of cash for work, public infrastructure rehabilitation, and community security interventions at speed and scale in areas most affected by the conflict as soon as they become accessible, is a meaningful and highly effective way for UNDP to engage early on in conflict contexts. In northern Mozambique, UNDP's positioning today is unprecedented thanks to these interventions implemented well before those of humanitarian and development partners. The experience in northern Mozambique further illustrates that a stabilization-focused approach is suitable under certain circumstances in displacement settings and allows for tangible engagement in the triple nexus. That said, stabilization approaches are highly political and therefore require systematic high-level engagement with the government through various channels to establish and maintain government buy-in.

The AAR finds that UNDP's surge planning and crisis response mechanisms worked efficiently in Mozambique. Some shortcomings with regards to the use of the stabilization concept as an initial component of the response as well as to stabilization-related capacity pools were identified, however, and should be addressed on a priority basis.

With regards to the extent to which key recommendations of previous AARs have been implemented during the Cabo Delgado response, progress has been made on more adequate contract modalities, surge planning & phases, the use of scenario planning and a UNDP signature methodology for needs assessments. In terms of missed opportunities to act on earlier AAR recommendations, continuous corporate follow-up after surge plan approval through CMST and Crisis Board structures did not take place. Also, CO capacities to absorb the anticipated additional workload were not assessed and addressed during surge planning. UNDP's corporate audit methodology has not changed and continuously disincentivizes effective crisis leadership and informed risk taking. In addition, central bureaus are continuously struggling to provide implementation support, be it with regards to strategic communications, operations management or resources mobilization. Finally, UNDP has yet to unpack the Nexus concept so as to provide practical guidance to country offices and it has not yet addressed the coordination vacuum stemming from the abolishment of the Early Recovery cluster.

Corporate findings and recommendations

In terms of corporate leadership of the response, the Regional Bureau for Africa provided strong strategic guidance and pro-actively accompanied the implementation of the Cabo Delgado response. In fact, UNDP has demonstrated an “all in” approach to the crisis, as illustrated by the significant resources invested by RBA, CB

and BMS. However, UNDP's crisis response strategy has not yet incorporated stabilization as a core concept and systems are accordingly not yet established to effectively drive stabilization interventions.

The response mechanism from needs identification to the approval of the surge plan / business case has overall proven to be responsive and functional. Some initial delays during needs identification could have been avoided but did not impact the response in any major way. Also, while the finalization of the sub office business case required an additional 6 weeks after submission, this period in fact served to align the strategic vision of involved parties for the response and therefore added value.

Decision-making on deployments and resources allocation was swift and adequate. However, surge planning and the development of a comprehensive programme strategy was prioritized over the launch of immediate activities. The AAR suggests that it might have been beneficial to fast-track and experiment with immediate response interventions in parallel to the design of the response programme.

Relevant fast-track procedures were used effectively in implementing the response. Yet, operational bottlenecks during implementation occurred and could have been avoided if country office capacities to absorb the additional workload had been assessed during surge planning. Moreover, formal corporate follow-up on the implementation of the response did not take place. This certainly is a missed opportunity and could have helped to identify and address capacities and strategic issues such as the pending signature of the project document.

Deployments were done with exceptional speed and efficiency. However, UNDP capacity pools for stabilization experts and head of sub office profiles are insufficient and need to be gradually expanded and improved through deliberate practice experiences. The significant size and composition of the surge planning team (1st wave: 9 advisors) was meant to kick-start the UNDP office in Pemba. However, its size during surge planning posed coordination challenges, and was seen to prioritize programme over operational capacities.

Surge advisors with an operational profile experienced in civil works and cash-for-work management are critical for stabilization interventions. The Mozambique response highlighted difficulties to find and deploy these profiles and UNDP should therefore continuously develop related capacity pools. It would have also been beneficial to team up international and local colleagues for mission-critical operations functions (security, procurement) from the outset.

Corporate implementation support from central bureaus (BERA, BPPS, BMS) was limited to the initial set-up phase. The lack of engagement between CO, RBA and BMS on stabilization-related operational challenges is a missed opportunity. Also, no dedicated resources mobilization support through a BERA-led RM Task Force as per UNDP Crisis Response SOPs was provided corporately. Given that UNDP's crisis engagement generates over \$3 billion delivery annually, it is surprising that UNDP has not yet established a more efficient corporate advocacy and resources mobilization capacity. Relatedly, little evidence was found for strategic communications driving and supporting UNDP's positioning in Cabo Delgado, and beyond Mozambique in the immediate crisis response space.

Priority recommendations for UNDP at **the corporate level** identified in the AAR are:

- **Stabilization as core crisis offer:** Integrate stabilization as a core element into the UNDP crisis response offer, including the design of a default stabilization package, conceptual clarity on the link between stabilization and the triple nexus, the establishment of a corporate support team, and pro-active corporate communication of this offer to partners and donors.
- **Advisor pools:** Actively develop a pool of experienced stabilization practitioners (programme & operations) as well as Heads of Sub Office and expand the pool of Portuguese-speaking Surge Advisors.

- **Crisis Praxis Experiences:** Expand crisis academy activities to include 3-6 months “practice experiences” for academy graduates, especially in the field of stabilization.
- **UNDP’s needs assessment methodology:** Build on IDA and SEIA to develop a holistic albeit practical UNDP needs assessment methodology for crisis settings, i.e., integrate infrastructure damage, socio-economic impact and social coherence / security aspects.
- **Implementation Support:** Central bureaus (BMS, BPPS, BERA) to review / define their offer and capacities to support the implementation of crisis responses; and to identify and train bureau-level focal points to systematically engage in ongoing crises.
- **Pro-active resources mobilization:** Establish a corporate capacity that provides hands-on advocacy and resources mobilization support to L2 and L3 crises.
- **Strategic communications:** Standardize the BERA strategic communications offer for L2 and L3 crises and provide dedicated communications training to surge advisors and inner-circle consultants with a communication profile.

Country-level findings and recommendations

In terms of country-level leadership and strategy, the Resident Representative has provided continuous hands-on guidance to the CD crisis response. The consistent and balanced engagement with key authorities in Cabo Delgado translated into a strong relationship despite the complex institutional setting. It is now critical to ensure balanced, strategic engagement with the national government, accommodating the complex institutional landscape and political economy. While UNDP has until now been the only operational actor in the most crisis affected districts, UN sister agencies and other development partners are gradually engaging in these zones in view of the evolving security environment. This will require UNDP to establish strategic partnerships with select sister agencies, especially in addressing questions of return.

The concentration on stabilization activities in high-risk areas has positioned UNDP uniquely. While the surge plan proposed a sequenced, two-pronged strategy with an initial focus on IDP and host community support, only stabilization interventions were implemented following a strategic decision in July 2021. In this context, it needs to be noted that the surge plan was developed while the crisis was still acute. Most affected areas only became accessible after the arrival of Rwandan troops in CD.

The immediate focus of the Cabo Delgado response now should be to scale up stabilization activities. The completed Infrastructure Damage Assessment (IDA) is a useful tool in this regard, while the lack of socio-economic data collection represents a gap for targeting, planning and monitoring purposes. Moreover, the provincial government requests to expand activities to include reconciliation and the development of a new narrative for Cabo Delgado. This constitutes an interesting opportunity to scope and gradually engage in broader area-based recovery programming. It is noteworthy in this context that the SDAC mission “SAMIM” is highly appreciative UNDP’s collaboration and proposes additional partnerships in the area of community security and the rule of law.

The establishment of the sub office was overall efficient, thanks to the presence of surge advisors with related experiences. For future cases, the updating of corporate content and the preparation of a two-pager with key business processes for the establishment of local presences will be helpful. The current sub office structure, especially supervision arrangements of key staff involved in the implementation of the Cabo Delgado response has created significant inefficiencies and slowed down the response. This should be reviewed and adjusted as a priority. Moreover, there is today an opportunity to further enhance CO-SO integration and communication. There also is a need to strengthen the common vision and to promote team coherence of the Sub Office team. Moreover, the sub office has yet to define workflows in key areas (including procurement and travel) and complete related staff training.

UN premises in Pemba are currently not blast-secure and UNDP should therefore continuously assess, and update involved risks, ideally in partnership with sister agencies.

The sub office financial sustainability model was realistic; however, Sub Office staffing should have been projectized, i.e., IPSA/NPSA contract modalities should have been proposed in the Surge Plan instead of FTAs for most of the staffing. The country office pro-actively reallocated funding from various sources to enable the launch of the Cabo Delgado response. While donors should have been involved in the process from the outset, the practice nevertheless represents a good lesson.

While not without challenges, the use of the third-party recruitment agency CTG to access red areas and kick-start stabilization activities has allowed UNDP to intervene early and continuously in crisis-affected areas. In collaboration with the recruitment agency, UNDP should now review and improve security and social security arrangements for CTG-recruited staff.

UNDP's partnership landscape with regards to the CD response is as complex as can be expected and requires a diversified and tailored strategy. The continuous involvement of authorities at CD level in activity planning and implementation is highly appreciated. This should now be complemented with regular technical and strategic engagement of authorities at the national level. Donor perceptions of UNDP with regards to the Cabo Delgado response are positive. This is an achievement to be celebrated. In fact, there is an opportunity for UNDP to spearhead donor coordination on stabilization and reconstruction in the Northern Provinces since donors want to be involved more strategically.

At the same time, sister agencies at the Maputo level have mostly been challenging UNDP's stabilization approach raising concerns about a possible expected negative impact on the humanitarian response. Yet, UNDP did establish solid working relationships with the same agencies. It will be important to clarify UNDP's role continuously and unapologetically in man-made conflict settings and to establish additional programmatic partnerships with select agencies, including UNHCR.

Communications around stabilization have been extremely timid and should be scaled up now that the proof of concept has been delivered.

Priority recommendations for the **country office** identified in the AAR are:

- **Sub Office Management structure:** Review the SO structural set-up, especially supervisory arrangements to enhance management coherence and efficiency.
- **Sub Office workflows and systems:** Define key sub office workflows (business processes) and train staff.
- **Sub Office security measures:** Engage in a dialogue with sister agencies to re-evaluate risks and update the SRM. The option of a joint UN compound that would allow for improved blast mitigation should be considered if other measures can no longer lower the residual risk to acceptable levels.
- **CO capacities and workflows:** Conduct a light CO capacity and workflow (business process) review to avoid bottlenecks in 2023 during the scale-up.
- **Donor coordination:** Establish a "Friends of UNDP" donor group on stabilization, also venturing into nexus territory.
- **National Reconstruction and Recovery coordination:** Establish a working-level, technical coordination platform for stabilization involving key ministries, and explore support to the establishment of a national PRCD & PREDIN-related partner coordination forum in collaboration with RCO.
- **Local Coordination of Reconstruction and Recovery:** Pro-actively support the local PRCD & PREDIN coordination platform to drive coordination through technical and secretariat support.
- **Partnerships with UN sister agencies:** Establish a strategic partnership with one or two suitable sister agencies, including UNHCR, to strengthen UNDP positioning with regard to durable solutions (return).

- **3rd party workforce:** Review and improve security arrangements and social security package of CTG staff jointly with CTG.
- **UNDP's role:** Clearly define and communicate UNDP's new role, including stabilization, in man-made crisis response settings to sister agencies, OCHA and international partners.
- **Strategic communications:** Seeking support from BERA, craft UNDP's story in Cabo Delgado and showcase its interventions through more regular and more strategic communications.

For the full set of prioritized recommendations, please refer to annex 7.6 and 7.7.

2 Introduction

The present After Action Review took place one and a half years after the start of the surge response. This timing allows, in addition for a review of the immediate surge period, to gain a better understanding of whether and how UNDP's significant up-front investments during the surge period into the launching of a comprehensive stabilization approach have been relevant, successful, and sustainable.

2.1 Context of the conflict

The conflict in de Cabo Delgado region in northern Mozambique, now approaching its sixth year, is described by key analysts to be among the gravest threats to peace and stability on the continent.¹ It further compounds and amplifies the effects of the devastating cyclones Idai and Kenneth that hit south-eastern Africa in March and April 2019. While responding to the effects of the two cyclones, Mozambique experienced an intensification of security crises in the northern provinces adding to the humanitarian caseload. The acceleration of conflict in mid-2020, with the growing involvement of regional and international terrorist groups and the structural local grievances led to a crisis level declaration by several UN entities, including UNDP.

Figure 1: Distribution of Multi-Dimensional Poverty in Mozambique since 1996



(Source: Multidimensional Poverty Peer Network / Oxford University 2022)

A review of poverty data, specifically its geographic distribution in Mozambique from 1996 to 2019 reveals that the northern provinces have been and still are most affected by multi-dimensional poverty. Together with Zambézia province, Cabo Delgado today is by far the most deprived province in Mozambique. In other words, structural poverty is a key characteristic of the northern provinces and coincides with cyclone and conflict-induced reductions of living standards. It certainly also is among the root causes of the conflict.

¹ International Crisis Group Briefing 178 from 10 February 2022: "Winning Peace in Mozambique's Embattled North".

Following a UN Regional Directors' mission to Mozambique mid-December 2020, UNDP convened a Crisis Board meeting to take stock of the growingly complex security situation in Cabo Delgado and the neighboring provinces of Nampula and Niassa, and its impacts on UNDP's programme. The crisis board was instrumental in providing a comprehensive crisis response package leading to the rapid deployment of required capacity and allocation of emergency funding.

The situation, however, deteriorated dramatically end of March 2021 – 20 days after the deployment of first responders – as insurgents attacked and overran the town of Palma, killing dozens of people and uprooting thousands. The crisis was further compounded by a fragile situation of chronic underdevelopment, consecutive climatic shocks, and recurrent disease outbreaks including cholera, measles, and typhoid fever. The human toll of this violence has been grave, with more than 3,000 killed and nearly a million displaced. By September 2021, over 800,000 internally displaced people were partially located in relocation camps and informally hosted by vulnerable communities across Cabo Delgado, Nampula, and Niassa provinces.

UNDP's response was initially focused on emergency relief providing support to IDPs and recovery and development-oriented solutions for communities in Cabo Delgado, but gradually shifted to the implementation of stabilization interventions in the 6 most conflict-affected districts (Mocimboa da Praia, Nangade, Palma, Macomia, Quissanga, Muidumbe).

2.2 Scope and Deliverables

Align to its Terms of Reference (ToR), the objective of this AAR is to assess the relevance, efficiency, and effectiveness of UNDP response to the armed conflict in Cabo Delgado (Mozambique) in 2021. The AAR will examine the performance of UNDP in responding to the crisis in Mozambique and will identify lessons learned that have the potential to strengthen the functioning, performance, and efficiency of UNDP responses to similar future crises in the Africa region and beyond.

In addition to reviewing corporate support and implementing the response at the country level, the AAR is expected to generate findings and recommendations that help improve the efficiency and cost effectiveness of the UNDP crisis response systems and tools, particularly in displacement-related complex emergencies and stabilization settings.

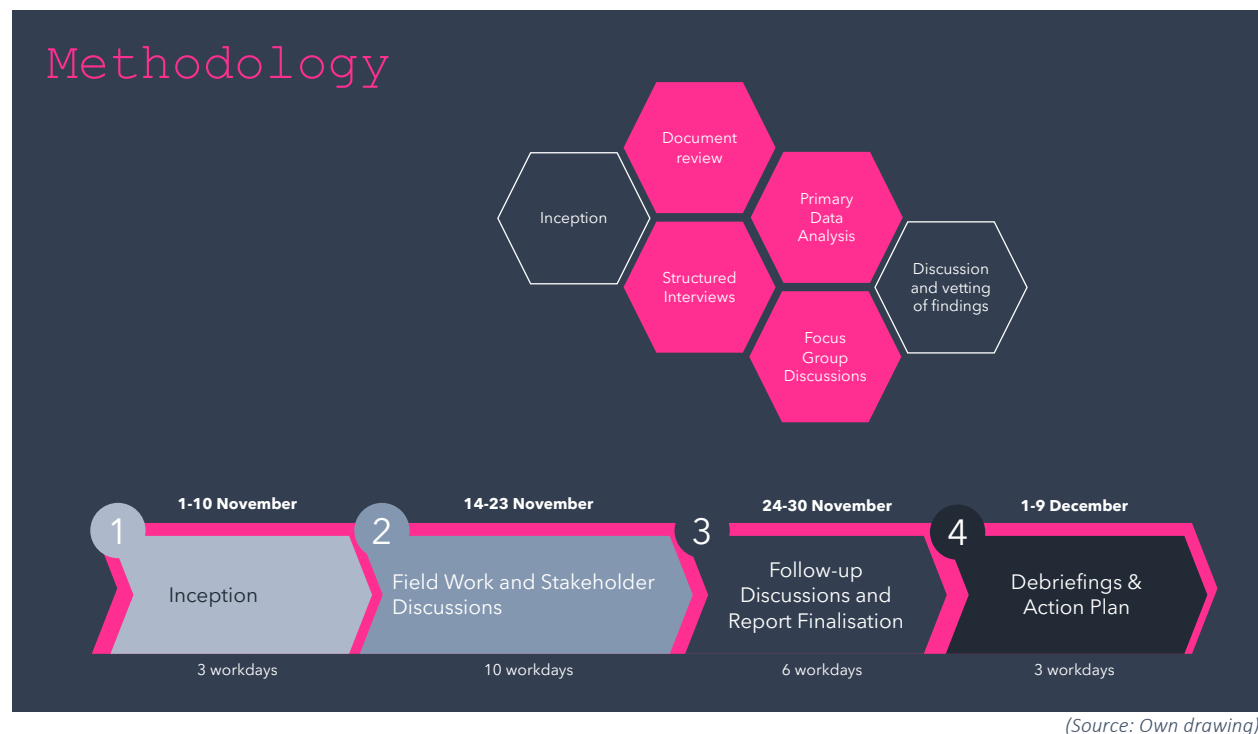
The review will also establish the extent to which UNDP has taken on board its own recommendations as expressed in relevant AARs from the past 5 years.

2.3 Methodology

The review was conducted in 4 phases: The inception phase entailing a desk review, initial stakeholder discussions and the development of an inception report. Field work and stakeholder discussions were then conducted in Maputo and Pemba, followed by additional focus group discussions and stakeholder interviews upon return from Mozambique. Based on the presentation of emerging lessons and recommendations regarding the Cabo Delgado response, the report and a proposed action plan was finalized and vetted by the Crisis Bureau, the Regional Bureau for Africa, and the Mozambique Country Office.

The review has attempted to facilitate a positive and open organizational learning process confirming approaches that worked well and should be continued; identifying new, innovative approaches that could be mainstreamed and integrated in future crisis responses; and approaches that did not work well and should be discontinued or revised. It has been collaborative and consultative in nature, drawing on the knowledge and experience of a broad range of internal and external stakeholders, including UNDP colleagues of all seniority levels at corporate and CO level.

Figure 2: Methodology and review sequence used during the AAR



Analytical framework

The After-Action Review of the Cabo Delgado crisis response distinguishes the corporate and country level and has used a set of guiding questions / key aspects to assess relevance, effectiveness and efficiency at each level, noting that the two levels are intrinsically linked.

At the **corporate** level, it has reviewed:

- Corporate Response Strategy & Coordination
- Corporate Response Mechanisms
- Deployments
- Deployment Support provided to individuals and the surge team
- HQ Implementation Support in a level 2 context (Mozambique)

With regards to the **country-level** response, the AAR has inquired about:

- Local Crisis Coordination Support
- Country Office Response Structure and Capacities
- Sub Office and Remote Management Structure
- Programmatic Response
- Operational Response
- Communication
- Partnerships and Resource Mobilization

Annex 1 provides a detailed overview of key aspects used to guide the review for each of these areas. Annexes 7.4 and 7.5 provide an overview of all interviews and focus group discussions conducted during the AAR.

3 Overview of the UNDP Response

3.1 Existing UNDP country office capacities

In 2020, the Mozambique country office delivery increased to \$33.5 million, from \$19.5 million in 2019 and \$7.8 million in 2018. The two increases of 70% and 160%, which happened mostly due to the response to cyclones, had required the country office in 2019/20 to strengthen its capacities, including establishing an office in Beira. Nevertheless, based on discussions with the country office team, operational capacity bottlenecks were felt during the second half of 2020, indicating that existing capacities were at least fully absorbed and possibly stretched by the existing programme delivery in March 2021 when the Cabo Delgado response was launched.

This is confirmed by a comparison of today's CO capacities with the general UNDP typology. As shown in figure 2, the country office resembles a regular "medium type" office, with some additional capacities in procurement. Given that the office is today running both, the cyclone recovery programme and the Cabo Delgado crisis response with related transaction types and levels, capacity bottlenecks in finance and possibly HR can still be expected today and were certainly already existing in 2020. This explains the idea proposed by RBA during the development of the business case for the sub office in Pemba to establish a strong and independent operations team in Pemba.

The country office and the surge team could draw on relevant technical capacities in the areas of rule of law, decentralization and community resilience, including programme staff and Chief Technical Advisors. As was established during the AAR, related exchanges were facilitated by the Resident Representative and two staff members of the governance unit actively participated in the design of the Cabo Delgado response. There was nevertheless a general sense among the surge team members and country office colleagues that these capacities were most effectively used, for a variety of reasons which will be discussed in the programme-related section below.

At the launch of the CD crisis response, UNDP capacities on the ground were limited to two project associates linked to the cyclone response without a dedicated office structure. While the United Nations presence in CD was generally limited, other agencies, including IOM, UNICEF, FAO, WFP, and UNHCR had already established presences in Pemba at the launch of the crisis response. Accordingly, an immediate task of the surge response was to assess the need and feasibility of establishing a local presence in Pemba and subsequently develop a business case and financial sustainability model for such a presence.

Figure 3: Mozambique Programme CO Delivery 2017 - 2022 (as of 7 Dec. 2022)

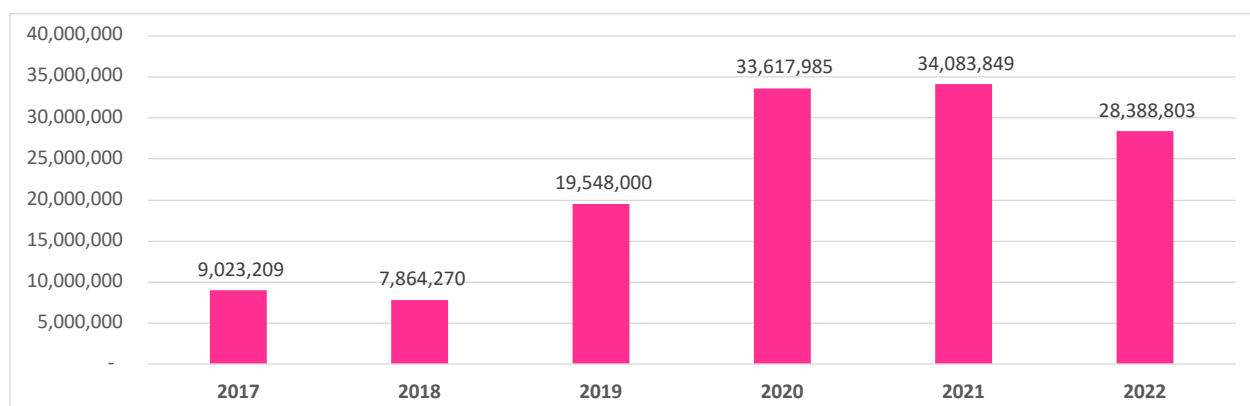
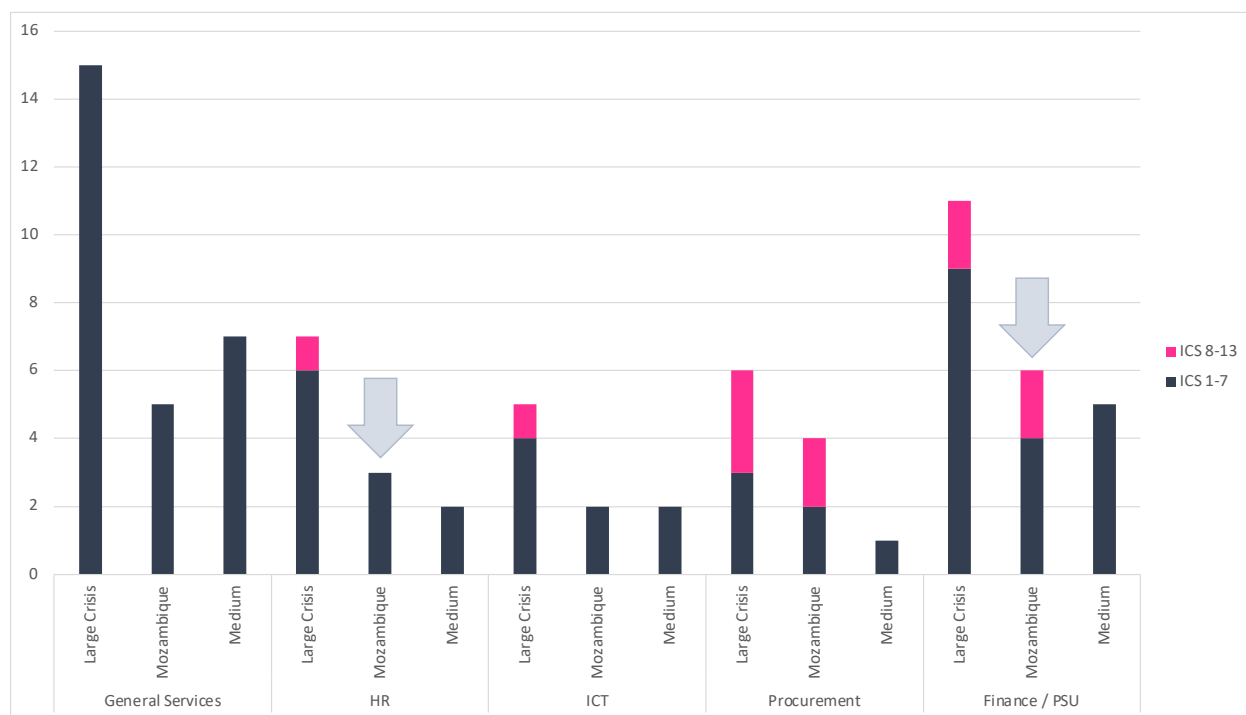


Figure 4: Comparison of CO Operations Capacities Mozambique 2022 vs UNDP Medium & Large Typology



(Source: Own drawing)

3.2 Contextual factors impacting the response

A number of contextual factors relating to the general operating environment, the institutional context and the composition of the agency representatives in CD impacted the UNDP response. First, the response took place during the tail end of the second COVID wave in Africa, complicating travel and partially restricting face-to-face collaboration of the surge team with partners.

Secondly, the national institutional arrangement in Mozambique was comparatively complex and unclear. At the national level, no single institution received the mandate to coordinate the national response to the crisis and the roles of involved ministries were overlapping, due to a complex political economy.² This contrasts with the post-cyclone recovery efforts, where the National Institute of Disaster Risk Reduction (INGD) under the Ministry of State Administration and Civil Service was responsible to coordinating the response from the start.

ADIN, the “Integrated Northern Development Agency” was created in March 2020 by the Mozambican Council of Ministers to promote multiform actions aimed at the socioeconomic development of the provinces of Cabo Delgado, Niassa and Nampula, and administratively placed under the Ministry of Agriculture. While its mandate includes inter-institutional coordination “to boost the region's integrated socio-economic development”, the coordination role for response and reconstruction efforts is kept by the council of Ministers at national level and by newly created platforms at provincial level co-chaired by the secretary of state and the governor (see figure

² See for example the governance framework of the Cabo Delgado Reconstruction Plan (PRCD) in Annex 2, published in May 2021, where national coordination is assigned to the Council of Ministers and further responsibilities distributed over a number of different ministries.

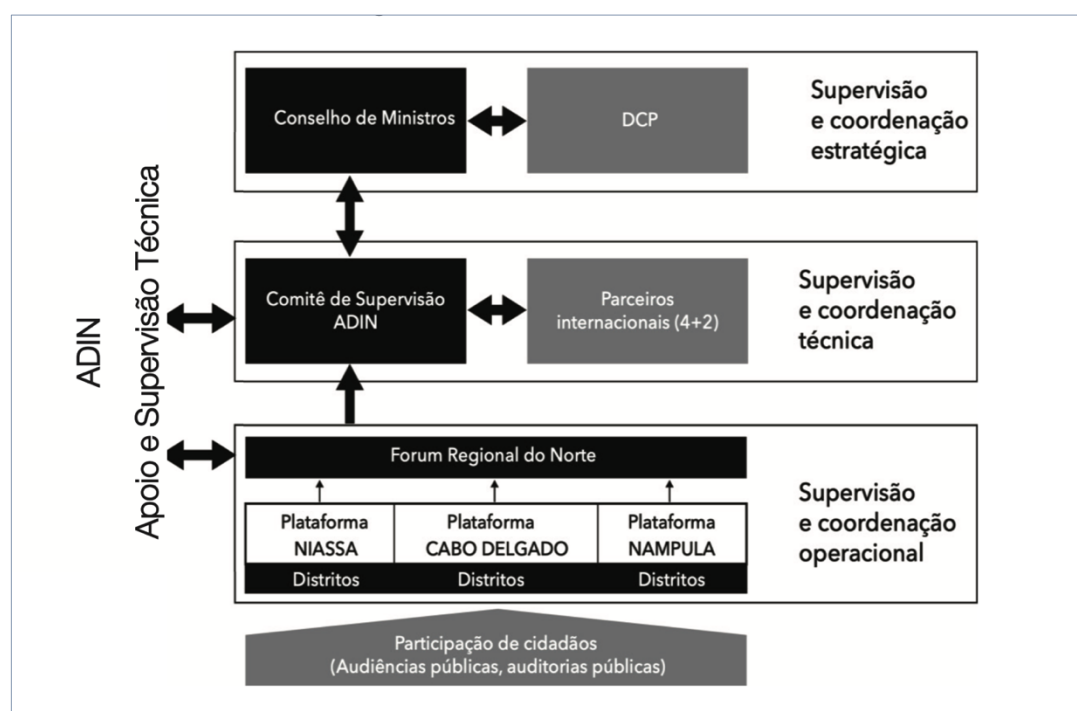
6). This complex national coordination structure produced unclarity as to which institution would be UNDP's counterpart for coordination of CD crisis-related activities.

"We are a public institution for the promotion of actions of a multiform nature with a view to the socio-economic development of the provinces of Niassa, Cabo Delgado and Nampula, endowed with legal personality, with administrative autonomy."

(Quote from the ADIN homepage)³

At provincial level, the distribution of roles between the elected governor of the province and the state secretary representing the national government at provincial level is still pending in light of the relatively recent implementation of Mozambique's decentralization policy. In fact, while Mozambique adopted constitutional reforms towards decentralization in May 2018, key legislation clarifying the actual scope of mandates of involved bodies was not yet enacted at the beginning of 2021. The resulting functional unclarity between Governor and Secretary of State certainly carried the potential to produce coordination and implementation challenges.

Figure 5: PREDIN Governance and Coordination Structure (Source: PREDIN Document)



Third, the institutional complexity was mirrored by overlapping and partially contradicting strategic frameworks, namely the PRCD, RPBA, and PREDIN. The PRCD was published in September 2021 by the Council of Ministers as a plan to coordinate reconstruction in Cabo Delgado, introducing a complex coordination structure (see annex 2). At the same time, the RPBA supported by the World Bank, the European Union and the UN as developed with UNDP playing a critical technical role in its elaboration. Upon conclusion, however, the government decided to develop its own response plan, PREDIN, nevertheless was heavily informed by the RPBA. The PREDIN was

³ See: <https://adin.gov.mz/quem-somos/> (accessed: 8 December 2022).

launched by the Council of Ministers in August 2022 without reference to the PRCD and introducing a separate governance structure (see figure 5).

Fourth, partner (donor) coordination in Mozambique is, in the words of a donor interviewed as part of the AAR, “unusually challenging”.⁴ In practical terms, functional partner coordination structures are still emerging today, which posed an additional coordination challenge to UNDP.

Fifth, many of the colleagues of sister agencies deployed in Cabo Delgado – according to interviews conducted with surge team members and UNDP staff in Pemba⁵ – did not have experience in complex, man-made crises and therefore not familiar with roles and mandates of agencies such as UNDP in these contexts. This not only translated into initial coordination challenges, but also to difficulties for the UNDP surge team to participate in joint assessment missions or benefit from OCHA Civil Military coordination services.

3.3 Timeline of events and surge actions

After the escalation of the crisis in Cabo Delgado during the second half of 2020 including the capture of the coastal town of Mocimboa de Praia by Al-Shabaab in June and a massacre in Muidumbe district at the beginning of November during which over 50 people were killed, the United Nations fielded a Regional Director Mission to Mozambique and Cabo Delgado from the 13th to 18th November 2020. The head of the sub-regional platform in Nairobi represented UNDP. In her BTOR issued on the 13th January 2021, the UNDP representative recommended a scale-up of UNDP activities and convening a UNDP crisis board.

It is recommended that RBA considers the possibility of convening the Crisis Board to review the crisis in Cabo Delgado and declare the adequate crisis level to ensure UNDP's adequate preparedness and response. In this regard, UNICEF and UNFPA have already declared Level 2 crisis in Cabo Delgado.

(Quote from the RD Mission BTOR, 13 January 2021)

The BTOR also provided an initial programmatic vision, including (1) responding to and recovering from the humanitarian crisis; (2) preventing further violence and stabilize; and 3) investing in long-term development and resilience in the Northern Region of Mozambique and advocated for “focused triple H-D-P Nexus investments”.

The first CMST meeting was convened three weeks later, on the 10th of February 2021, which concluded with the recommendation to prepare an Exigency Memo and hold a Crisis Board as soon as possible. The preparation of the exigency memo took 2 weeks, finalized on the 23rd of February and right in time for the first Crisis Board meeting on the 24th of February 2021.

During the Crisis Board meeting, the RBA Deputy Director emphasized the need to act quickly and avoid delays in positioning UNDP in the region and recommended launching an integrated stabilization package. The board concluded with the approval of the deployment of a first wave of surge advisors to support the surge planning process and cover critical functions, including establishing an office in Pemba and designing an integrated programme portfolio. Approved deployments were:

1. Surge Team Leader
2. Sub-Regional Security Specialist for East/South Africa (BMS-supported)

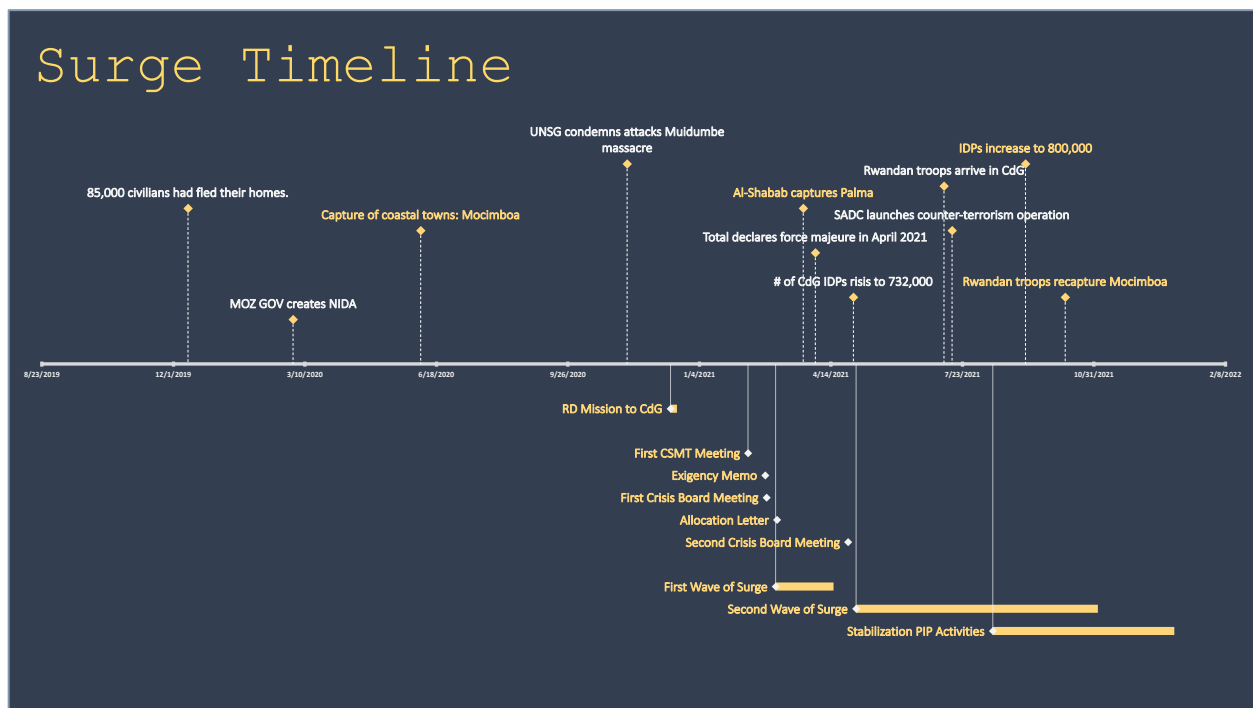
⁴ Interview conducted with a UNDP donor on the 17th November 2022.

⁵ Interviews conducted virtually and in situ between the 9th November and the 9th December 2022.

3. Operations Advisor
4. Communications Specialist
5. Gender Specialist
6. Stabilization Advisor
7. Social Cohesion Advisor
8. Resource Mobilization Specialist
9. Resources Mobilization Analyst - Surge Experience (remote support to RM Specialist)

The team of first responders was deployed to Pemba one week later, on the 3rd of March, for one month in parallel with the issuance of the allocation letter (4th March 2021). Installing itself in a hotel in Pemba with adequate working facilities in view of Covid restrictions, the team developed a business case for establishing a sub office including a comprehensive programmatic vision, a detailed staffing structure for the sub office and a financial sustainability model.

Figure 6: Surge Timeline (see annex 3 for larger version; source: own drawing)



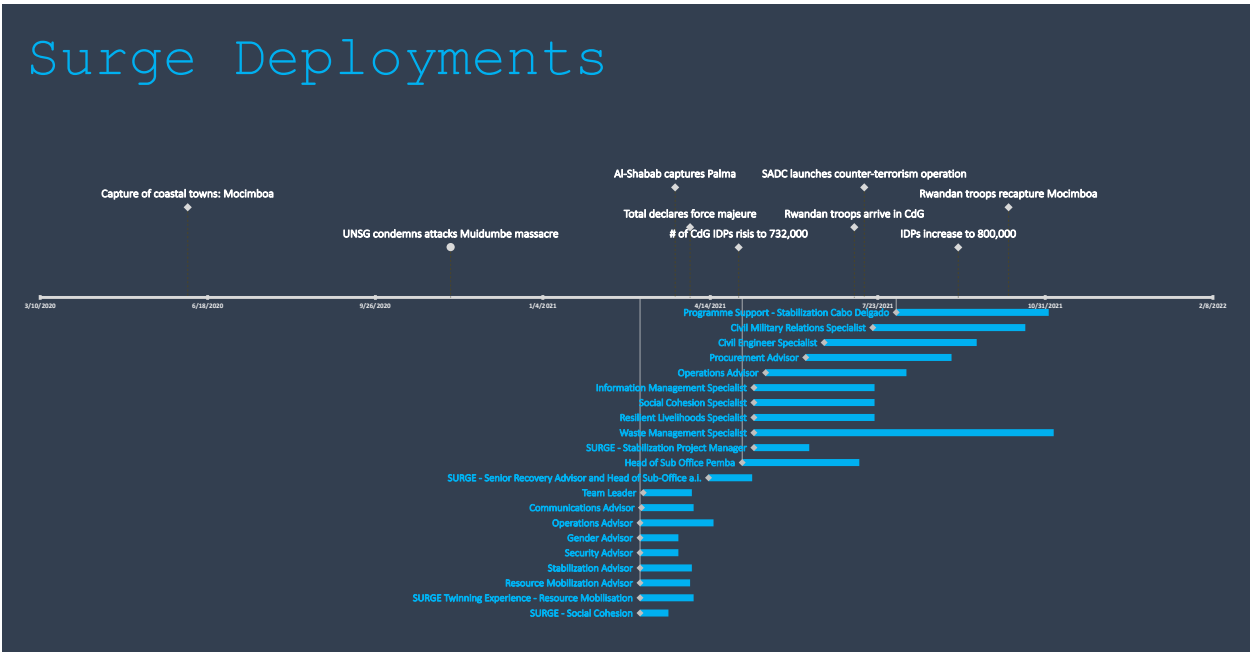
The business case was approved on the 16th of May, 3 weeks after the second Crisis Board on the 27th of April 2021 and following significant exchanges between the surge team, the CMST and RBA. The latter led to the further calibration and finetuning of the business case (for a more detailed discussion of the calibration process, please refer to the below section on the programmatic response). As reflected in the funding model of the sub-office, the total funding requirements for recruitment of staff, deployment of the Surge capacities (2nd wave), office setup and running costs was estimated at \$4.5 million for the period 2021-2023, while available resources amounted to \$4.56 million based on an assumed delivery of the Cabo Delgado sub office of \$10.5 million in 2021, \$21.5 million in 2022 and \$18.3M in 2023 to generate the DPC needed (6.5%) to sustain the office. The business case proposed a review and confirmation of office sustainability in 2023.

The sustainability model included upfront investments for the initial surge-supported staffing of the office (\$900K), RBA-supported operational costs (\$329K) and for BMS-supported security upgrades (\$300K). Over the following 1.5 years, total corporate investments into the Cabo Delgado Operation amounted to \$5.25 million

(1.1 million TRAC 3, 250K Rule of Law Global Programme, 3.6 million TRAC 2 and 350,000 Security Office funds). With regards to funding for programmatic activities, the UNDP country office in collaboration with the surge team had identified funds for reprogramming mostly stemming for the EU-funded decentralization programme and the multi-donor funded cyclone-related Mozambique Recovery Facility (MRF).

The business case approval triggered the deployment of a second wave of surge advisors and ExpRes Roster consultants spanning from the 3rd of May to the 3rd of November 2021. During the second wave the Sub Office was established, and a stabilization programme developed, and a Programme Initiation Plan launched targeting key districts affected by the conflict. First stabilization activities on the ground were launched on the 15th of August 2021 (see figure 6).

Figure 7: Surge Deployments (see annex 3 enlarged version; Source: Own drawing)



4 Findings and Recommendations

The presentation of AAR findings and recommendations follows the analytical framework used during the review. Please refer to annex 1 for research categories and questions.

4.1 Corporate Level

Corporate Vision & Response Strategy

1. **The Regional Bureau for Africa provided a strong strategic vision and pro-actively accompanied the implementation of the Cabo Delgado response.** As documented in the Crisis Board minutes and confirmed in interviews, the strategic leadership of the Deputy Regional Director, especially the strong emphasis on stabilization in most affected areas, was critical to achieve the outstanding positioning that UNDP has today in Cabo Delgado. Importantly, the senior level engagement was not limited to strategic discussions but also consisted in pro-active engagement in the finalization of the surge plan / business case and the identification of adequate profiles for the surge team.

2. **UNDP has demonstrated an “all in” approach to the crisis in Cabo Delgado, as illustrated by the support from RBA, CB and BMS.** The corporate investments of \$5 million over 1.5 years into the establishment of the sub office and the launch of stabilization activities go significantly beyond the level of investments usually done in level 2 crisis contexts and further illustrate the strategic vision supporting the crisis response. Moreover, the collaboration between CB, RBA and BMS with regards to cost sharing and different types of support was noted as positive by all involved colleagues. Moreover, the interaction between regional bureau and crisis bureau was described as unbureaucratic and effective by several accounts.

3. **UNDP’s crisis response strategy and systems have not yet incorporated stabilization as a core component of the response.** This finding relates concomitantly to strategic, programmatic and operational aspects. At the strategic level, the excellent conceptional work done by the Crisis Bureau Stabilization Academy has not yet translated into actionable response modules that are organizationally understood and embraced. It is interesting to see, at the same time, that the “early recovery” concept continues to be widely seen as the core building block of UNDP’s response. It is important to note that both concepts are complementary: early recovery interventions can build on stabilization achievements. Moreover, stabilization and more complex recovery interventions can be implemented in parallel targeting different geographic zones. This will require, however, leaders and staff experienced with the implementation of both approaches. In the case of Cabo Delgado, the unprecedented strategic positioning was achieved through an exclusive focus on stabilization in the most crisis-affected areas (please refer to the below section on programmatic aspects of the response for a more detailed discussion).

Corporate Response Mechanisms

4. **The response mechanism from needs identification to the approval of the surge plan / business case has proven to be highly functional, with the required responsiveness.** The mechanism was implemented in full alignment with UNDP’s crisis response SOPs, and the overall timeframe of 2.5 months from the first CSMT meeting to the approval of the surge plan demonstrates adequately swift action. In fact, as can be seen in figure 6, the sequence of steps from first CMST meeting to the launch of stabilization activities including the deployment of 2 subsequent surge advisor waves has been without any major delay, except for the approval of the surge plan / business case for the Sub Office. After the submission of the draft plan by the surge team to CB and RBA, discussions and refinement of the business case continued for approximately 6 weeks. The business case was finally approved on the 16th of May, 3 weeks after the 2nd Crisis Board. This “back-and-forth” was due

to a difference of views between the surge team and the regional bureau with regards to the way that stabilization interventions were included in the plan.⁶ The finalization process was widely seen as time-consuming and tedious, and it could be argued that this exchange would have ideally taken place early, notably during the planning period. However, since the discussion was strategic and meaningful, the author does not see this time investment as “wasted” or “unnecessary”.

5. **Decision-making on the response and resources allocation was swift and adequate.** The decision-making with regards to the surge deployments and allocations were made swiftly, using the structures governing a response (Crisis Board, CMST) adequately to ensure coordination and implementation support. This finding is highlighted since this is in positive contrast to other responses of comparable urgency and scope.

6. **Delays during needs identification could have been avoided and likely slowed down implementation of initial response interventions.** A key delay detected with regards to the response refers to the time between the Regional Director mission that ended on the 18th of December 2020 and the first CMST meeting held on the 10th of February 2021. It can be argued that the scope of crisis in December 2020 did not require highest organizational priority, as also demonstrated by the later assigned L2 response level. At the same time, some colleagues have expressed the opinion that UNDP could have launched the first interventions significantly earlier, in February rather than in August, if the first CMST had happened before end of the year 2020. In fact, the mission BTOR was submitted early January and submitted to the Crisis Bureau late January. It would have been more efficient, from an organizational point of view, if (a) RBA had informed CB of the mission and launched the Mozambique-related collaboration in December, and (b) if the BTOR had been made available to RBA and CB in parallel.

7. **Fast-tracking of immediate response interventions should have been considered.** While it can only be speculated whether fast-tracked stabilization interventions could have attenuated the subsequent escalation of the crisis peaking with the takeover of the coastal town of Palma in March 2021, the following alternative scenario is illustrative: first, the BTOR of the assessment mission could have been made available within days after the end of the mission and the CMST could be organized instantly. Second, an initial surge planning team could have been fielded before end of the year based on CMST recommendation, while the first Crisis Board could have already approved the business case. Third, and importantly, the UNDP crisis response mechanism should have supported the CO instantly, already during the first surge wave, to experiment with and implement initial stabilization interventions which could have indeed launched as early as February 2021. In the view of the author, this would have required a small, operational (i.e. experienced and trained) stabilization / rapid response team to be deployed alongside a team of 2-3 surge advisors developing the surge / business plan. Moreover, experiences with initial stabilization implementation would have informed the business plan and would have allowed for showcasing vis-à-vis international partners and donors.

8. **Comprehensive surge / programme planning was prioritized over the launch of activities.** It is recognized that the security situation during the first half of 2021 characterized by the ongoing crisis including the takeover of Palma by Al-Shabaab in March posed significant obstacles to the immediate implementation of activities. Nevertheless, planning and scoping efforts continued until early August 2021, even though initial recovery interventions, including in displacement-affected areas, and initial stabilization interventions closer to the crisis affected districts could have likely been kicked off much earlier. In the opinion of the author, experimentation with such initial initiatives would have been beneficial to continuous programme development and UNDP positioning. An ensuing recommendation therefore is to focus future surge planning exercises on the development of a programmatic vision and the swift establishment of capacities required to launch initial, experimental activities. The development of a comprehensive programme can be gradual and accompany activities implementation.

⁶ See below points 31-32 for a discussion of the proposed response strategy, including the proposed 2-pronged approach.

9. **There was a gap in terms of formal, corporate follow-up once the business case had been approved.** Specifically, a 3rd Crisis Board mid-way or towards the end of the crisis response was never organized.⁷ Such formal follow-up would have been critical to identify relatively early on the strategic / political problem experienced by the country office with regards to support at the national level for UNDP's stabilization programme and the subsequent signature of the project document. This issue was only resolved in November 2022 through the intervention and support of the Deputy Regional Director, over a year after the project document had been submitted for signature by the Resident Representative. The 3rd Crisis Board would have been the adequate forum to identify this bottleneck in good time and agree at the strategic level on steps to resolve the issue.⁸

10. **The SO financial sustainability model is realistic; however, Sub Office staffing should have been projectized.** The financial sustainability model of the sub office assumes a \$50 million delivery of the years 2021 – 2023 and a DPC charge of 6.5 percent, which translates into an approximate annual delivery target of \$20 million and \$1.3 million target of DPC. Based on the hard pipeline for the crisis response in November 2022 amounting to over \$60 million and various examples of DPC models, this assumption can be seen as realistic as long as staff costs are directly budgeted rather than charged as a percentage fee on projects. Given the importance of the Sub Office structure to remain flexible, however, the proposed contract modality for sub office staff – except for the Head of Sub Office and the Operations Manager – should have been IPSA / NPSA rather than fixed term and fully projectized.

11. **The underlying principles of the CO audit conducted during the implementation of the crisis response were unhelpful and disincentivized the effective implementation of the crisis response.** The question of Sub Office sustainability has been picked up by the country office audit conducted in August 2021, during the active crisis response. While parts of the analysis of the audit team are correct, the conclusions are misleading and disincentivize an effective implementation of the response. Moreover, it is surprising that the country office has been penalized for a business case that has been corporately reviewed and approved at the highest level. This is most certainly unhelpful in a moment when the country office is attempting to strategically position UNDP in Cabo Delgado. It illustrates a continuously ill-conceived audit logic that penalizes country offices and managers for informed risk-taking. The underlying issue, which has already been discussed in the 2019 Yemen / Hodeidah after-action review, needs to urgently be addressed by UNDP if it wants its managers in crisis contexts to remain functional and effectively engage in crises.

12. **Some of the fast-track procedures were used effectively; others were not relevant.** The AAR found that the Pemba team, in close collaboration with the country office, effectively used different possibilities for fast-tracking procedures. In fact, seven (or 50%) out of the 14 mainstreamed fast-track procedures were used, at least to some extent, in implementing the Cabo Delgado response (see below table 1 for an overview; and annex 7.8 for details and challenges). Both country office and headquarters colleagues confirmed the relevance and usefulness of the following procedures. Specifically, the CO received increased Micro-Purchasing threshold to \$10k as well as HR-fast track recruitment for 10 TAs and 20 NPSAs. With regards to the possibility to increase the procurement threshold, this was not granted in view of an unsatisfactory audit report in November 2021. With regards to the direct ACP / BMS review of procurement cases, this might become relevant in 2023, once all stabilization funds will be received and the scope of procurement activities increases. Petty cash and project

⁷ See the provisions of the Crisis Response SOPs: *"The third and final Crisis Board meeting (CB#3) will take place after the CO approves the programme initiatives for recovery and/or resilience-building based on the CO reprogramming exercise, the Surge Plan and any agreed change management action. The Crisis Board will review resources in case there is a financial gap between the SURGE period and mobilizing other resources. The final Crisis Board meeting will mark the completion of the crisis response period unless the Crisis Board extends the original crisis response duration or recommends a new crisis response level."*

⁸ This finding has been discussed with the CO, RBA and CB, and the author is aware of its controversial nature. He nevertheless believes that the 3rd Crisis Board would have been instrumental to identify, address and resolve this issue earlier.

direct cash advances were not required by the Pemba operation, mostly because cash-for-work interventions relied on mobile payments from the outset. In summary, there is no specific recommendation on the fast-track procedures emanating from the Cabo Delgado experience so far. This might change in 2023 when the scope of stabilization interventions increases significantly. Accordingly, it is recommended for CB and BMS to review fast-track related questions with the Pemba-based Operations Manager after the first quarter of 2023.

13. **Country office capacities to absorb the additional workload related to the Cabo Delgado response were not assessed, therefore creating bottlenecks.** This is another recurrent finding of After-Action reviews. While capacity requirements for the new team – in this case the sub office in Pemba – were carefully assessed, the details of the Sub Office – Country Office workflows, the additional transaction load for the Maputo team and possible capacity gaps at Maputo were not assessed. While the explicit intention was to establish a self-sufficient operational hub in Pemba which would possibly also absorb workload from the existing Beira office, this plan was not followed through: Pemba continued to be operationally dependent on the Maputo office, especially as it relates to payments and procurement – two areas where key delays were consistently encountered.⁹ A key recommendation therefore is to include anticipated workflows and transaction levels as well as capacity needs of the central CO team into the surge planning process.

Deployments

14. **Deployments were done with exceptional speed and efficiency.** This finding confirms that the UNDP surge mechanism is functional and effectively used to support crisis responses. It is worth noting that the Mozambiquan authorities were not issuing visas during the response period. An exception was made, however, to providing note verbales to those with UNLPs. This limited deployments to staff with LPs during the first wave. For the second wave, remaining TAs that had been assigned to ExpRes by BMS on an exceptional basis during the Covid-19 response were repurposed and used to deploy consultants through the TA modality, and their Laissez-Passez fast-tracked. This innovative practice has ensured CB ability to rapidly deploy and is worth replicating in future: several of “pending TAs” should be always held pending by ExpRes for response purposes. The **adequacy of profiles** of the deployed surge advisors and ExpRes Roster consultants during the 2 waves has received mixed reviews. The seniority and experience of the team lead and core advisors was appreciated. It has been noted, however, that half of the deployed colleagues of the first wave was inexperienced with surge planning, which reduced their effectiveness on the ground. Moreover, a concern was raised with regards to the difficulty to identify and deploy an experienced stabilization advisor. With regards to this specific profile, it was suggested that an expansion of UNDP’s expert pool is critical to guarantee the organization’s capacity to deploy required capacities in this substantive area rapidly.

15. **UNDP capacity pools for Stabilization Experts and Head of Sub Office profiles, as well as for Portuguese speakers, are insufficient.** There de facto is only a very limited number of field-experienced surge advisors or consultants suitable to running sub offices and to planning and implementing stabilization interventions. Both are relatively specific profiles and require practical experience to effectively engage in a crisis response. In the Cabo Delgado case, the Crisis Bureau in fact did not manage to identify an experienced stabilization advisor for the first wave of deployments, while the turn-over of the head of sub office position was too high and therefore negatively impacted UNDP’s representational and strategic engagement with counterparts, sister agencies and donors. It is therefore recommended, certainly with regards to the stabilization practitioner pool and possibly also with regards to the HoSO pool, to expand the learning scope of the crisis academy to combine theoretical training with the possibility of practical experiences during 6-month deployments in crisis and stabilization

⁹ For payments, please note that the Pemba Sub-Office did not receive HQ Treasury approval to have a separate bank account as Mozambique CO already had the maximum allowed bank accounts. Resulting bottlenecks slightly improved when the OM appointed a specific person in Finance Team in Maputo to support Pemba Stabilization. Nevertheless, payment delays are continuously experienced. For procurement, the P3 Procurement Specialist was based in Maputo instead of Pemba. This decision was taken to address Maputo-level bottlenecks, which should have been identified and addressed during surge planning.

settings. For instance, graduates of the stabilization academy should be subsequently deployed for at least 3 (better 6) months into active stabilization operations to develop the practical skills and experiences required to effectively operate in a stabilization-related crisis response context. In addition to an expanded pool of stabilization practitioners, such initiative would be a welcome opportunity for individual learning and staff development. Furthermore, the pool of trained Surge Advisors speaking Portuguese should be expanded while, when necessary, surge teams need to be equipped with dedicated translators.

16. The size and composition of the surge planning team (1st wave) posed coordination challenges. With the immediate deployment of a comprehensive team of 9 advisors, the intention was to establish the core of a UNDP sub office team in Pemba that would ensure early positioning in addition to surge planning. This intend of the CB to experiment and innovate must be seen as a positive initiative, and it is confirmed that the team size allowed UNDP to be more present in consultations and engagements with counterparts and partners. At the same time, the team size and composition did not translate into the immediate launch of experimental activities as per above findings eight and nine. Moreover, team members pointed to significant logistical and coordination challenges of such a large team during the planning process. Concluding from the experience, it is recommended to limit the size of future surge planning teams to three or four experienced colleagues, while ensuring that the second wave which should include all required profiles identified during the planning phase will be deployed swiftly after the conclusion of the planning phase.

17. The surge team composition was seen to prioritize programmatic over operational capacities. Some colleagues interviewed expressed the concern that operational aspects have been deprioritized over programmatic aspects, which in this view can be seen in the composition of the first and second wave deployments. In this context, it was suggested that the first wave team should have included a procurement advisor to do a rapid local and national market analysis. In the view of the author, two aspects need to be distinguished. First, when it comes to the surge planning process, the presence of an experienced operations advisor side-by-side with an experience programme advisor is sufficient to identify operational challenges and capacity needs. Second, with regards to the kick-starting of activities, a strong operational capacity including a procurement advisor and a finance specialist will be essential. Therefore, a decision needs to be taken upfront on whether the first wave should only focus on surge planning, or whether this wave should also kick-start initial activities. In the latter case, it is recommended to deploy two parallel teams under the leadership of the surge coordinator: one team of 3 colleagues focusses on surge planning, while the second team concentrates to the launch of immediate activities. Of course, both teams should coordinate closely and mutually inform each other's activities.

18. Detailed pre-assignment briefings of surge advisors were only provided to some of the deployments. This gap was felt by several of the second wave advisors and consultants, and the benefits of a pre-deployment briefing discussion with each candidate seem obvious: improved mental readiness, the possibility to establish contacts with additional resource persons before the assignment, improved subject-matter preparedness. This holds especially true since several deployed colleagues were not trained surge advisors. Such a preparatory briefing would ideally be done in collaboration between the CB CSMT and the surge team leader.

HQ Implementation Support in the Cabo Delgado level 2 context

19. Corporate support from central bureaus in supporting the implementation of the response was limited to the initial set-up phase. Specifically, no evidence was found for support (a) from BMS on operational aspects such as procurement or the establishment of cash-transfer systems, (b) from BERA to support resources mobilization for the response beyond the development of an initial resources mobilization strategy, or to drive communication efforts at international level, and (c) from BPPS to programmatically accompany the response. This is a recurrent finding in a number of after-action reviews and points to a systemic problem. As argued for instance in the AAR report of the 2019 Yemen / Hodeidah response, central bureaus have little crisis response

experience and are de facto not structured, nor prepared to provide implementation support. Given the strategic, reputational and financial implications of crisis responses for UNDP corporately, it is surprising that this issue has not yet been addressed by the organization.

20. **The lack of engagement between CO, RBA and BMS on stabilization-related operational challenges is a missed opportunity.** Each response provides ample opportunities to experiment and innovate with regards to Central Bureau support.¹⁰ In fact, the Mozambique country office requested an engagement of BMS on possible support to the implementation of time-sensitive stabilization interventions in August 2021. The request was acknowledged at HQ level, but the actual engagement never happened. While it is beyond the scope of this AAR to establish and discuss involved factors, this instance certainly represents a missed opportunity. This instance also further illustrates above finding No. 9, whereby such engagement could have been decided by the Crisis Board and facilitated by the CMST.

21. **Little evidence was found for strategic communications driving and supporting UNDP's positioning in Cabo Delgado, and beyond Mozambique in the immediate crisis response space.** The surge planning team has produced (i) a communication plan, including identification of priority communication activities for the 3 months period and (ii) a detailed resource mobilization plan with proposed specific activities. However, experience from various crisis responses shows that communication and resource mobilization plans are often not used, which can be explained by a continuously evolving context and capacity limitations of the country office. Moreover, no notable communication and / or advocacy products were produced during the immediate response period of 6 months. This must be seen as a major missed opportunity, because UNDP's response in Cabo Delgado would have been an excellent opportunity to showcase UNDP's relevance in the immediate response space and its ability to do meaningful NEXUS-related work side-by-side with the humanitarian sister agencies. Hands-on support from the BERA communications team, such as through a dedicated focal point, would have been helpful in this regard and is certainly recommended for future responses.¹¹

Textbox 1: Corporate-level recommendations

Recommendations:

1. **Stabilization as core crisis offer:** Integrate stabilization as a core element into the UNDP crisis response offer, including the design of a default stabilization package, conceptual clarity on the link between stabilization and the triple nexus, the establishment of a corporate support team, and pro-active corporate communication of this offer to partners and donors.
2. **Advisors pool:** Actively develop a pool of experienced stabilization practitioners (programme & operations) as well as of Heads of Sub Office, and expand the pool of Portuguese speakers.
3. **Crisis Praxis Experiences:** Expand crisis academy activities to include 3-6 months "practice experiences" for academy graduates.
4. **Central Bureau Support:** Central bureaus (BMS, BPPS, BERA) to review / define their offer and capacities to provide support to the implementation of crisis responses; and to identify and train focal points to systematically engage in ongoing crisis.
5. **Strategic communications:** Standardize the BERA strategic communications offer and support for L2 and L3 crises and provide dedicated communications training to surge advisors and inner-circle consultants with a communication profile.
6. **Pro-active resources mobilization:** Establish a corporate capacity that provides hands-on advocacy and resources mobilization support to L2 and L3 crises.

¹⁰ After the 2010 Haiti earthquake, for example, BMS Procurement took over the management of critical initial procurement processes, while BPPS supported the assessment of NGO capacities in the framework of an IP prepositioning exercise.

¹¹ Please note that a discussion with the BERA Communications Office has been requested on the 14th of December to fact-check and refine recommendations, but no response was received as of 16 Jan 2023.

7. **UNDP's approach to CO audits:** Review audit principles and objectives to ensure that pro-active crisis management and informed risk-taking will be incentivized and rewarded.
8. **Surge Planning:** Evolve surge planning to consist of (1) a light programmatic visioning process, (2) scenario planning, and (3) the assessment of workflows, CO main team capacities and capacity gap identification.
9. **Activity fast-tracking during 1st surge wave:** Integrate the launch of immediate, experimental response activities into the first wave of surge deployments.
10. **Deployment preparation:** Systematically conduct pre-assignment briefings to advisors and consultants. \
11. **Implementation follow-up:** Ensure effective follow-up and support during response implementation through the CMST and Crisis Boards.
12. **UNDP's needs assessment methodology:** Build in the IDA and SEIA to develop a holistic albeit practical UNDP needs assessment methodology for crisis settings, i.e. integrate infrastructure damage, socio-economic impact and social coherence / security aspects.
13. **Establishment of Sub Offices:** Update corporate POPP content and produce a 2-pager with key steps and flows to inform future surge missions.

Table 1: Use of Fast-Track Procedures during the Cabo Delgado response (see annex 7.8 for details and challenges)

Area	Special Measures	Used?
Procurement Management	Individual Contract	No
	Increased Delegated Procurement Authority (IDPA)	No
	ACP/BoM Review	No
	Low-Value-Shopping/Purchase	Yes
Human Resource Management	Fixed-Term Appointments	Yes
	Temporary Appointments	Yes
	NPSA Contract recruitment	Yes
	Staff Administrative Services	No
Financial Resource Management	Project Cash advances	No
	Petty Cash	Yes
	Single Signatory	No
Partnerships	Partnerships Agreements	No
ICT Management	ICT Supply Services	Yes
Project Management	DIM Authorization	Yes

Table 2: Surge Deployments

Wave	Last Name	First Name	Months	Modality	Gender	Assignment Title
1	Koulibaly	Aboubacar	1.0	SURGE	Male	Team Leader
1	Fernandes	Claudia	1.0	SURGE	Female	Communications Advisor
1	Kouadio	Yacin	1.5	SURGE	Male	Operations Advisor
1	Zimmerman	Jessica	0.6	SURGE	Female	Gender Advisor
1	Friedrichs	Christian	0.8	SURGE	Male	Security Advisor
1	Jung	Hyewon	1.0	SURGE	Female	Stabilization Advisor
1	Wanjiru	Lucy	1.0	SURGE	Female	Resource Mobilization Advisor
1	Bassano	Marco	1.1	SURGE	Male	Resources Mobilization Analyst (Surge Experience)
1	Knudsen	Mads	0.6	SURGE	Male	SURGE - Social Cohesion
2	Cloubou	Agboessi	3.0	TA	Male	Civil Military Relations Specialist
2	Abu Shaaban	Mohammed	3.0	SURGE	Male	Civil Engineer Specialist
2	Al Ali	Hanan	2.9	SURGE	Female	Procurement Advisor
2	Sinemani	Roseline	2.8	SURGE	Female	Operations Advisor
2	Oremo	David	2.4	TA	Male	Information Management Specialist
2	Griffith	Lara	2.4	TA	Female	Social Cohesion Specialist
2	Leira	Azul	2.4	TA	Male	Resilient Livelihoods Specialist
2	Jore	Getaneh	6.0	TA	Male	Waste Management Specialist
2	Morier	Florian	1.1	SURGE	Male	SURGE - Stabilization Project Manager

2	Castro	Craig	2.0	SURGE	Male	Head of Sub Office Pemba
2	Pichat	Stephen	1.0	SURGE	Male	Head of Sub-Office / ER Advisor
3	Cornelissen	Yanthe	3.0	ExpRes	Female	Programme Support (remote)

4.2 Country Level

Positioning, Strategy and Leadership

22. **UNDP's positioning today in Cabo Delgado is unprecedented, largely thanks for its emphasis on stabilization interventions in highly affected districts.** After the approval of the business case and in discussion between the RBA Deputy Regional Director and the Resident Representative, UNDP took the decision to concentrate on stabilization as opposed to a broader engagement in IDP and host community support. Indeed, through its dedicated team in Pemba the country office has managed to meaningfully engage and implement stabilization interventions in the most affected districts well before other humanitarian and development partners. This fact strongly supports the expansion of stabilization interventions in Cabo Delgado.

23. **The Resident Representative has provided critical support and leadership to the CD crisis response, which was appreciated by surge and sub office teams.** The surge team leaders and Heads of Sub Office appreciated the availability of the RR to provide guidance and / or rapidly approve processes as per the requirements of the Pemba team. Given the political nature of stabilization interventions, this constructive and hands-on engagement was critical for UNDP positioning and speedy implementation.

24. **The consistent and balanced engagement with key authorities at all levels in Cabo Delgado translated into a strong relationship despite the complex institutional setting.** All authorities encountered during the AAR in Cabo Delgado emphasized their appreciation of UNDP and signaled full support, including the Governor, the Office of the State Secretary, the Head of ADIN and 6 District Administrators. Factors of appreciation were the fact that only UNDP had launched public infrastructure rehabilitation, community security and cash-for-work interventions in the most conflict-affected districts and the consultative approach to establish and implement Joint Action Plans for each of the districts emphasizing national ownership.

25. **It is critical to accompany a swift locally coordinated crisis response with a strategic and balanced engagement with the national government.** The signature of the project document was delayed by over one year. As far as the AAR could establish, this unexpected delay was encountered due to a combination of several factors including competition between involved Ministries (Agriculture, Finance, Public Administration, Interior), deliberately competitive positioning of the World Bank, and insufficiently balanced and early technical engagement of the national level in the development of the project. This finding highlights the importance to accompany a swift localized crisis response with a strategic and balanced engagement with the national government. Specifically, it would have likely been beneficial to engage all involved Ministries early on in technical working sessions culminating in a Local Project Appraisal Committee so as to gradually build and maintain the political buy-in of the national government.

26. **With the changing security environment, UN sister agencies and other development partners are now equally engaging in the 6 most affected districts, also addressing questions of return.** UNDP's excellent positioning is for the time being based on its pursuit of a "blue ocean" strategy of engagement in the least crowded geographic areas. With the changing environment, it will be critical to expand the scale and scope of interventions as soon as possible. Moreover, UNDP should establish a strategic partnership with one or two suitable sister agencies to strengthen its positioning in a durable solution / return setting. UNHCR likely is the most important and suitable partner in view of its complementarity of mandates and existing corporate agreements.

National and Local Crisis Coordination

27. **Support provided to coordination at provincial level is appreciated at should be formalized.** At provincial level, in Cabo Delgado, UNDP is providing informal coordination support to the coordination platform established by the PREDIN, which is appreciated by the three involved government parties (Governor's office, State Secretary's office, ADIN). It is firmly recommended to formalize this support through the provision of technical and secretariat support to the platform. UNDP should also consider providing similar support to the platforms in the two other northern provinces.

28. **There was and still is an opportunity for stronger UNDP engagement in national and partner coordination of the crisis response.** As explained earlier, the national institutional arrangements for crisis coordination were comparatively complex and unclear, which was mirrored – in the view of several bilateral donors interviewed – by an ineffective partner coordination structure. Several partners believe that UNDP could have added significant value in establishing and supporting an efficient national and partner crisis coordination structure in close collaboration with the Resident Coordinator. This would have been in full alignment with its mandate, even if it is recognized that the distribution of roles between UNRCO and UNDP in this area still requires clarification. Mozambique could still serve as a positive example of collaboration between RCO and UNDP. In fact, the RC is currently attempting to establish a comprehensive programme for the Northern provinces, accompanied by an information management system. Whilst the likelihood of success for this programme is in the view of the author rather low and the need questionable, the coordination gap certainly needs to be addressed and UNDP's experience in this regard will be needed.

29. **UNDP felt the absence of the early recovery cluster and struggled to define its role in a NEXUS setting.** The Mozambique Cabo Delgado crisis has so far not allowed the United Nations to make any progress in unpacking what exactly a NEXUS approach entails. Instead, the country team descended into the usual humanitarian – development duality, with unnecessary competition and conflicts crystallizing around resources mobilization and intervention spaces. This, and the fact that UN agency staff and representatives had no or only limited experience in a man-made disaster setting presented significant challenges for UNDP to define a collaborative place within HCT and the cluster system. The fact that the Early Recovery cluster does not exist anymore and has not been replaced continues to complicate UNDP positioning. A good illustration of this are (1) the discussion around the use of armed escorts when accessing high-risk districts, and (2) the discussion as to whether stabilization interventions in conflict-affected areas would create pull factors for premature returns. Two recommendations emanate from this experience. First and at the corporate level, UNDP needs to urgently, unapologetically, and forcefully define and clarify its role in a response to a man-made crisis. Second and at the Mozambique level, UNDP should drive the establishment of a coordination forum at both national and provincial level that its co-chaired by the government and focusses on questions related to reconstruction, local governance, rule of law and return. Given the nature of these questions, this de facto is nexus coordination. Whether however it is strategic to call it by its name needs to be decided in discussion with the government and friendly partners. The European Union for one has expressed its strong interest to be part of such a structure and would support it politically.

Programmatic aspects of the response

30. **UNDP's response was launched while the crisis was still acute, and programmatic planning required plausible future scenarios as done by the surge plan.** As can be seen in figure 8, the conflict intensity (as measured in fatalities per months) was still high during the first half of 2021, including the capture of the coastal town of Palma on the 24th of March 2021, during the deployment of the first surge wave. In the environment characterized by uncertainty and limited information, programme planning needed to consider several future scenarios and propose separate engagement priorities for these. Specifically, as confirmed by all team members

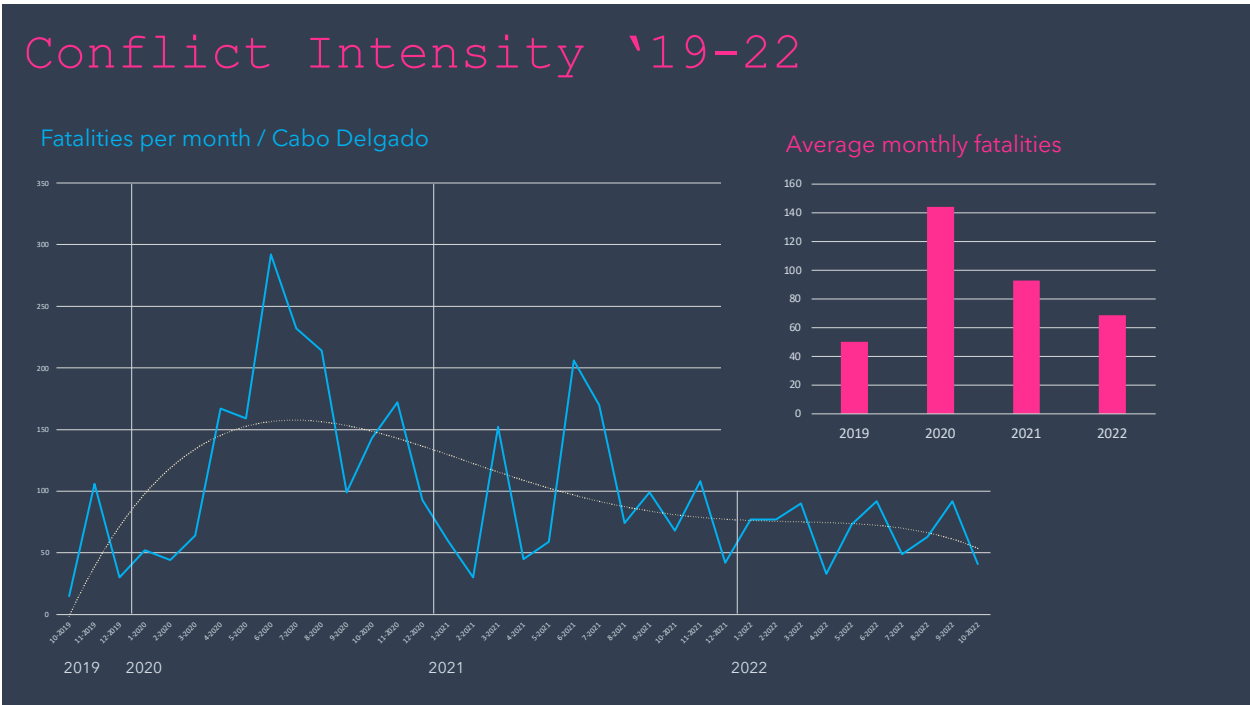
including the sub-regional security advisor, in March 2021 it was uncertain whether and when UNDP would be able to access the northern “red” districts. The high-quality business case accordingly proposes:

“UNDP’s approach and programme represent a combination of interventions that will fit any eventuality in the quest to support people in Mozambique/Cabo Delgado to recover from crises, resist future shocks, achieve peaceful coexistence and free themselves from extreme poverty and exclusion. In the worst case scenario while the sub-office may not be fully established, stabilization initiatives may go ahead in areas accessible- that is those where security is established. Gradually this could be expanded and other recovery and transformative development interventions kick started as the security situation improves to other favourable scenarios.”

Business Case / Strategic and Operational Plan for Cabo Delgado as approved on the 16th May 2021

31. The surge plan proposed a sequenced, two-pronged strategy with a longer-term strategic outlook, with a focus on IDP and host community support during the first 6 months. The surge plan proposed a longer-term vision based on three broad programmatic pillars for the northern Mozambique consisting of (1) stabilization interventions, (2) socio-economic recovery, and (3) transformational change. It also proposed an implementation sequence of initial host community support and recovery interventions during the first 6 months, followed by 18 month of stabilization interventions, assuming that red areas would be accessible by then (see figure 9 below). On the one hand, this two-pronged strategy allowed for scenario-based adjustments to the intervention strategy depending on the evolution to the situation. On the other hand, the approach suggested an initial, exclusive focus on IDP and host community support activities in the safer southern districts. The ensuing scoping and assessment of possible interventions in the southern districts took 3 months after surge plan approval.

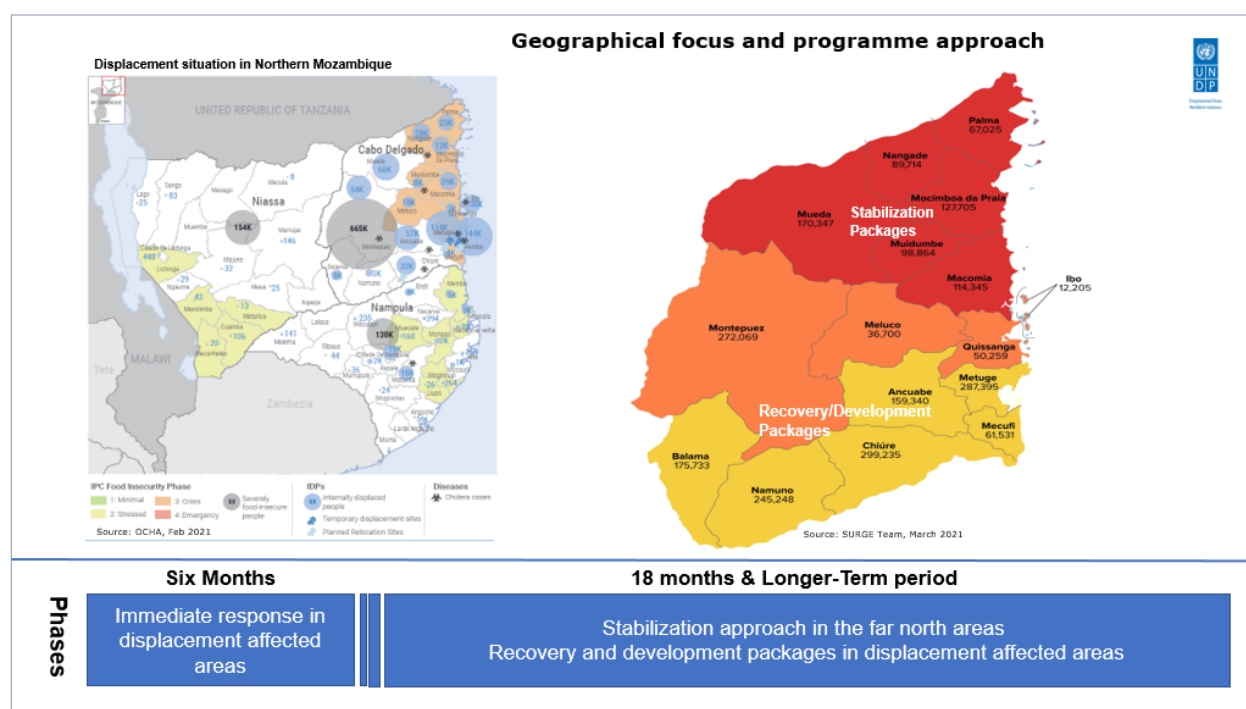
Figure 8: Changes to the conflict intensity 2019-2022 (as measured in fatalities per month)



(Source: Own figure based on ACLED 2022)

32. Following a strategic decision in July, only stabilization interventions were implemented as of August 2021. Due to insistence of the Regional Bureau and the RR, the Pemba team switched to an exclusive stabilization focus in July / August 2021. At this moment, Macomia and Quissanga districts were accessible again albeit with significant security precautions, largely due to the arrival of Rwandan troops in Cabo Delgado in July 2021. The AAR comes to the conclusion that earlier interventions in red districts would have not been possible. In fact, a mission to Palma was planned by the first wave surge team leader in March and cancelled days before Al-Shabaab took over the town. However, experimentation with “stabilization-type” activities (rehabilitation, cash-for-work, community security) in areas bordering red districts could have started earlier, especially since these would have required less scoping efforts as compared to IDP / host community support activities that needed to be coordinated with a range of national and local authorities and humanitarian actors.

Figure 9: Overview of the programme strategy proposed by the surge / business plan



(Source: Surge presentation to Crisis Board)

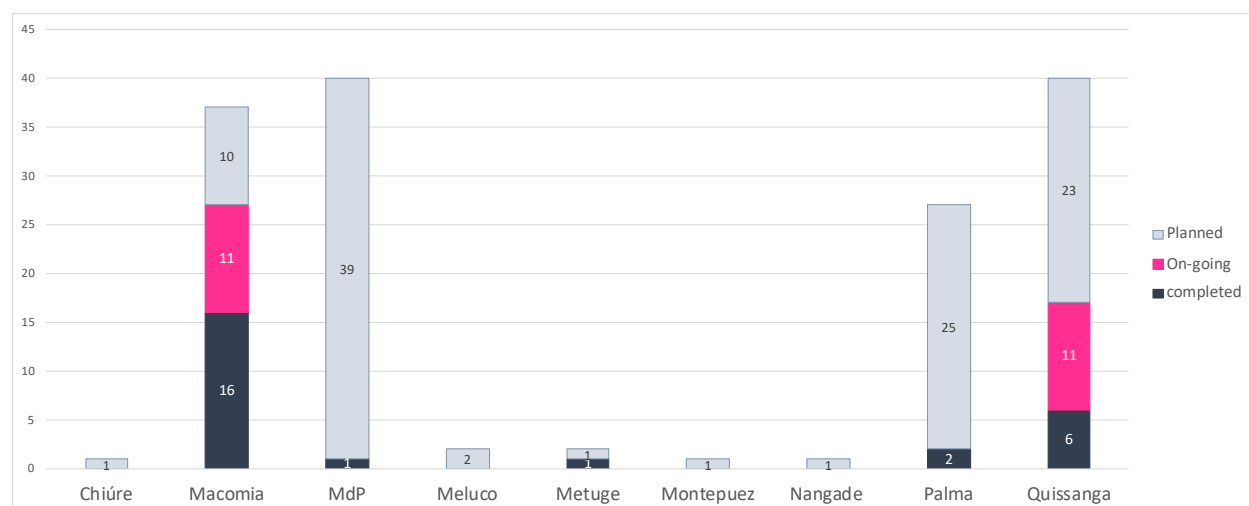
33. The concentration on stabilization activities in high-risk areas has positioned UNDP uniquely. Through the dedicated team in Pemba, the country office has managed to meaningfully engage and implement stabilization interventions in four of the six most affected districts well before other humanitarian and development partners and is highly appreciated by both the government and serviced communities. At the time of drafting of this report in November 2022, UNDP was still the only agency implementing activities in the “red” districts. It had completed a total of 26 infrastructure projects, 22 projects were ongoing and further 103 projects were planned (see figure 10 below).

34. An effort was made to enable exchanges and linkages between Maputo and Pemba colleagues during programme development. Programme colleagues responsible for Rule of Law, Decentralisation and Conflict Prevention were particularly active in the development of the response programme and continuously provided guidance for its implementation. At the same time, some programme colleagues felt and feel isolated from the Cabo Delgado operation. In fact, more regular presence of Cabo Delgado staff in Maputo will be helpful to close this gap, including regular updates and presentations from the Head of Sub Office to Maputo-based colleagues.

35. **The immediate focus of the Cabo Delgado response should be to achieve the major scale up of stabilization activities.** This scale-up should not be underestimated and will require continuous attention from the CO senior management. Based on available figures and scenarios, it is proposed increase the number of beneficiaries of cash-for-work interventions in 2023 from the initially planned 9,000 to at least 20,000 beneficiaries with the aim to reach 100,000 beneficiaries by the end of 2024.

36. **The Infrastructure Damage Assessment (IDA) is a useful tool support UNDP positioning and scoping of interventions; however, the lack of socio-economic data represents a critical gap.** UNDP finalized and published the IDA in August 2022, following an effort engaging the Pemba-based engineering team during the better part of the first half of 2022. It represents a high-quality analysis and an extremely useful set of data for the planned stabilization scale-up and continuous resources mobilization. The methodological and analytical support provided by the CB Surge Data Hub was much appreciated and critical in this context. This tool needs to be regarded as a major step forward for UNDP's ability to produce and own quality data for response planning. Given the time and effort it took to collect this data, however, it would have been strategic to collect at the same time socio-economic / livelihoods data and community perceptions with regards to conflict and security. Such a more comprehensive data set would support planning beyond infrastructure rehabilitation and strengthen UNDP's offer in the livelihoods and social cohesion space. It is recommended that the CB Surge Data Hub uses its excellent existing work on the SEIA to offer a more comprehensive assessment approach in future crisis responses. In the meantime, the UNDP Pemba team might be the right partner for a pilot experience in this regard.

Figure 10: Overview of Infrastructure Rehabilitation (as of October 2022)



37. **The government requests to expand activities to include reconciliation and the development of a new narrative for Cabo Delgado.** This has been expressed by the Governor during a discussion with the UNDP Deputy Regional Director for Africa and constitutes an opportunity for UNDP to gradually expand activities to other mandate areas as proposed in the strategic and operational plan. This can be pursued in parallel to the expansion of stabilization activities and will further strengthen UNDP positioning. It will also accompany the implementation either of the 3 durable solutions.

38. **SAMIM is highly appreciative UNDP's collaboration and proposes additional partnership in the area of community security and rule of law.** The SADC Mission in Mozambique (SAMIM) includes a civilian component, which is experimental for the time being. As explained by the Head of SAMIM, the Police Commissioner is

currently scoping future areas of engagement and would appreciate a partnership with UNDP. This partnership, which could be operationalized as part of UNDP's expanded community security interventions, should be seen as highly strategic and mutually beneficial.

Operational and financial aspects of the response

39. **Bottlenecks were encountered with regards to the processing of payments and procurement cases because workflows and capacity needs were not holistically reviewed.** As explained in discussions during the AAR, the operations team of the Cabo Delgado Sub Office was meant to be self-sufficient and manage all operational transactions of the Cabo Delgado operation, possibly also absorbing an important part of the continuous Beira MRF Cyclone response transactions.¹² However, this intention has not been thought through systematically as part of the surge planning or thereafter. De facto, the CD operation remains dependent on operational support from Maputo, especially with regards to the processing of payment and procurement transactions. The Sub Office has not been equipped with its own bank account, nor does it have its own CAP. Accordingly, payment and procurement processes have encountered significant bottlenecks and delays at Maputo level. Moreover, procurement and finance related capacity needs at Pemba-level have been underestimated. It is therefore recommended to review workflows and related capacity needs – especially in view of the planned scale-up – and to either strengthen the Maputo team or to increase self-sufficiency of the Pemba team.

40. **The country office pro-actively reallocated funding from various sources to enable the launch of the Cabo Delgado response.** While many country offices have struggled with this measure and therefore slowed down the operationalization of the response, the Mozambique Country Office has developed a creative, multi-dimensional programme funding model. This approach can serve as a best practice, except for the fact that donors should have been involved more transparently and actively in discussions on funds reallocations (as per their own request during AAR interviews).

41. **Surge advisors with an operational profile experienced in civil works and cash-for-work management are critical for stabilization interventions.** The Cabo Delgado experience has shown that a lack of procurement and finance staff with civil works / cash-for-work experience causes delays. Not only are surge advisors with this profile needed to efficiently kick-start operations. They are also required to train locally recruited operations colleagues. It is therefore recommended that UNDP systematically builds and expands the pool of stabilization-experienced operations staff.

42. **It would have been beneficial to team up international and local colleagues for mission-critical operations functions (security, procurement) from the outset.** Discussions with surge team members revealed that it would have improved team effectiveness if the security advisor and the procurement advisor had been teamed up with local assistants who have access to context-related information and understand the local language(s). This is a quick-win recommendation for future responses and depending on the context the local assistant can either be newly fast-track recruited or temporarily relocated from the country office.

43. **The temporary assignment of the Pemba-based Operations Manager to cover for the CO OM in Maputo slowed delayed the implementation of key operational strategies.** In March 2022, the Sub-Office Operations Manager was asked to fill in for the departing country office OM, a temporary assignment that lasted till the end of September 2022 (6 months), till arrival of new DRR-O. While it can be argued that in the absence of a signed

¹² Please note that this intention is not explicitly expressed in the business case. The Sub Office was equipped with a P5 level Operations Manager, a G7 Finance Associate and a G6 Procurement Associate, a G5 Procurement Assistant as well as a G5 Operations and Logistics Assistant. The P3 Procurement Specialist was based in Maputo.

project document and the arrival of pledged funds the CD transaction level was significantly lower than expected during this period, the temporary transfer of the CD OM to Maputo significantly delayed the implementation of key operation strategies for the Sub-Office, including creation of SOPs and training for new staff. It is the view of the author that rather than drawing on Pemba-level capacities, the CO in collaboration with RBA and CB should have brought an external capacity on detail.

44. **While not without challenges, the use of a third-party recruitment agency to access red areas and kick-start stabilization activities has allowed UNDP to intervene early in crisis-affected areas.** Certainly, there are ethical concerns relating to the use of third-party contractors in areas that cannot be accessed by UN staff. Also, this “2-classes citizen” system creates challenges on a day-to-day basis. In fact, CTG colleagues raised the concern that their work is not sufficiently recognized and rewarded during the AAR discussions. Skillful, mature leadership is required to effectively address this issue. At the same time, in the currently existing UN system arrangements, third-party recruitment is the only way to enable engagement in red zones. To reduce ethical concerns and associated risks, it is recommended to continuously provide CTG recruits with adequate security standards when engaging in these areas including government escorts and armed vehicles where needed.¹³ It is also recommended that UNDP engages with CTG management to review issues and jointly define practical measures to mitigate security risks. CTG is currently piloting a new software called “TAYO” that includes duty of care functionalities, and this interaction with UNDP might help further refine the software and approach.¹⁴

45. **Most UN premises in Pemba would be susceptible to blast damage in a changing threat environment for the city.** The SRM for Pemba should therefore be continuously assessed and updated, with UNDP actively contributing to the process. UNDP premises in Pemba are equipped with solid security features, thanks to the investments of the UNDP Security Office and the guidance of the Sub-regional Security Advisor. However, the security features at the premises will not mitigate effectively against an IED blast given the closeness of office spaces to the street. The same holds true for most of the UN sister agency premises and UNDSS-approved hotels in Pemba. This aspect was discussed with the UNDP Security Office in view of the evolving security environment in Cabo Delgado. For the time being and based on available data, the likelihood of an attack of Al-Shabaab on UN premises using IEDs is evaluated as low and the associated residual risk levels are acceptable. However, experiences in Somalia 2009 and 2012 as well as Nigeria 2011 suggest that such a possibility needs to be continuously evaluated through the SRM process. The option of a joint UN compound that would allow for improved blast mitigation should be considered if other measures can no longer lower the residual risk to acceptable levels.

Country Office Response Structure and Capacities, including the Sub Office

46. **The establishment of the sub office was overall efficient, thanks to the presence of surge advisors with related experiences.** The Pemba sub office was well established and well equipped within a relatively short period of time. This is mostly due to the exceptional investment of involved colleagues. Also, the presence of surge advisors experienced with the establishment of sub offices significantly facilitated the launch of the presence. From a procedural point of view, however, there is an opportunity for improvements. While UNDP’s POPP content¹⁵ on the establishment of local presences describes the most critical processes, this content is outdated and would benefit from updating. For future surge responses, it would also be beneficial to have a 2-pagers summarizing the most important steps and business processes for the establishment of a local presence.

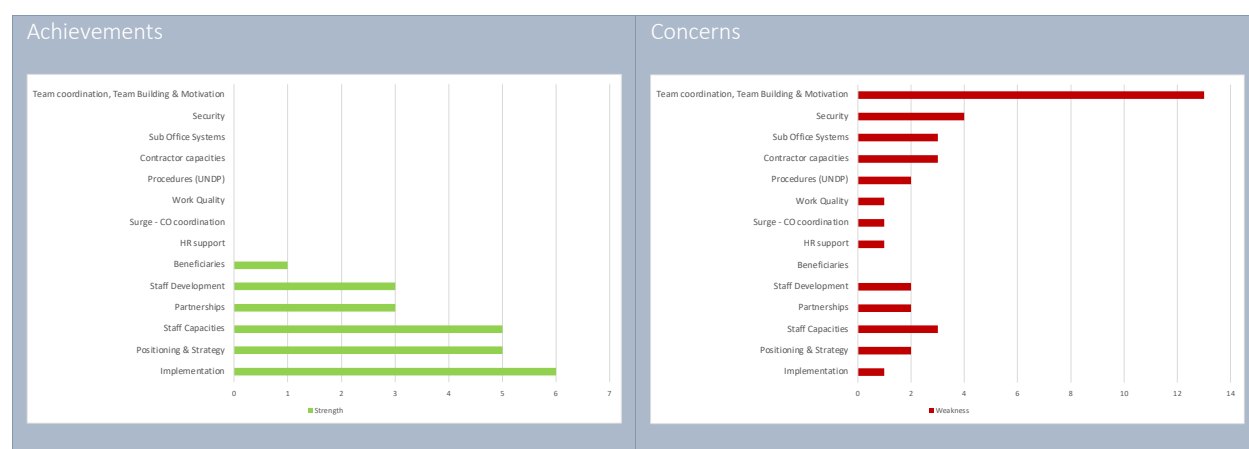
¹³ SSAFE & First Aid Trainings have been provided to CTG consultants with support from UNDP Security funds. VHF Radios, SAT Phones, and PPE gear is used by CTG staff for all missions.

¹⁴ For more details on Tayo, see: <https://ctg.org/work-with-us/tayo/>

¹⁵ <https://popp.undp.org/SitePages/POPPSubject.aspx?SBID=272&Menu=BusinessUnit>

47. **There is an opportunity to further enhance CO-SO integration and communication.** The establishment of a constructive and efficient relationship between colleagues in the main office and in the sub office is always challenging and requires clarity, instance and continuity of senior management engagement. In Mozambique, a number of formal and informal measures have been taken including a dedicated meeting between Maputo and Pemba based staff organized by the Resident Representative in August 2022, as well as the participation of the 2 Sub Offices Senior Managers in the weekly expanded management meeting. Nevertheless, availability of information and understanding of the Pemba operation in Maputo has been found to be relatively low. It is therefore recommended that Pemba office colleagues regularly brief the main office operations and programme teams on recent developments and progress as part of a formal monthly meeting. While this meeting can be held virtually, the regular physical presence of Pemba-based staff in Maputo and Maputo-based staff in Pemba will also greatly contribute to more effective collaboration.

Figure 11: Occurrence of key issues (Achievements, Concerns) raised during Pemba FGD, by category



48. **The organizational design, especially supervision arrangements, of key staff involved in the implementation of the Cabo Delgado has created inefficiencies and slowed down the response.** The setup found at the time of the review process involved (a) an interim P5 Head of Sub Office (HoSO) reporting to the RR and overseeing only 2 UNVs, (b) a P5 Operations Manager (OM) reporting to the RR and overseeing all Sub Office Operations Staff, and (c) a Head of the Stabilization Engineering Team (HoET) based in Maputo and reporting to the RR. While it is understood that this structure has grown organically in response to personalities and “chemistry” between involved colleagues, this structure increases conflict risks and cannot work efficiently. Identified current issues include the fact that the HoSO, who is accountable for progress of stabilization activities, cannot directly guide and oversee infrastructure rehabilitation (80% of stabilization in budgetary terms) and stabilization-related operations. Moreover, the HoET cannot provide daily guidance and supervision to the engineering team of 12 CTG colleagues due to his physical distance. It is therefore strongly recommended to review and adjust the current structural setup.

49. **There is a need to strengthen the common vision and to promote team coherence of the Sub Office team.** A snapshot of prevalent views and concerns among colleagues was taken during a focus group discussion with Pemba colleagues (see figure 11). The exercise revealed that SO colleagues are satisfied with the positioning UNDP achieved in Pemba. They value implementation progress, the partnerships they managed to establish and the existing capacities of UNDP in Cabo Delgado. At the same time, they are concerned about the absence of clearly defined workflows, security arrangements for frontline workers (especially CTG staff), as well as the capacities of contractors they are working with in Cabo Delgado. Most importantly, colleagues unanimously see a need to strengthen coherence and collaboration within the sub office team. It can safely be assumed that the

structural setup discussed in point 48 contributed to this perceived lack of team coherence. Nevertheless, senior managers of the Pemba team should address this issue in a collaborative manner without any further delay while the structural setup is being addressed.

50. The sub office has yet to define workflows in key areas (travel, payments, etc.) and complete staff training. This issue was raised by several colleagues of the Pemba team, many of them new to UNDP. In view of the imminent scale-up of stabilization activities the definition or design of key workflows (business processes) at Sub Office level as well as workflows involving the Main Office in Maputo and subsequent staff training is critical and should be made a priority together with the planning for the scale-up during the first quarter of 2023. Additional challenges due to the Quantum roll-out can also be expected and should be as much as possible mitigated.

Communication, Partnerships and Resource Mobilization

51. Donor perception of UNDP with regards to the Cabo Delgado response is very positive. The amount of \$45 million of funds mobilized (received and hard pipeline, as of December 2022) for stabilization is an achievement to be celebrated, and reflects the positive impression that donors have with regards to UNDP's response in CD. Donors feel that the stabilization programme complements ongoing humanitarian interventions and addresses in a very practical manner root causes the crisis in the northern provinces. The donor visit organized by the RR in collaboration with the head of stabilization and the partnership specialist in from the 10-12 March 2022 to showcase stabilization interventions was well received in this context.

52. There is an opportunity for UNDP to spearhead donor coordination on stabilization and reconstruction in the Northern Provinces since donors want to be involved more strategically. Donors expressed their desire to be more, and more regularly, involved in strategic discussions on stabilization. Several donor representatives also felt that they would have liked to be engaged in the design of the stabilization programme. The EU specifically expressed its disappointment that the question of reallocation of funds from MRF to CD crisis response were not directly and transparently addressed, which in the view of the EU is a missed opportunity to showcase adaptability and practical Nexus work. The request for more engagement certainly points to the possibility to establish a donor group to meet regularly on stabilization and reconstruction at Maputo level, which could initially be done informally while national coordination structures still fall into place.

53. Little RM support was provided from Headquarters. As far as the AAR could establish, funds mobilization efforts were exclusively driven at country level, with only limited support from BERA other than the release of a Resources Mobilization advisor for the initial surge wave to develop a RM plan and quality assurance for project proposals. This points to the fact that UNDP has still not managed to establish a hands-on resource mobilization & advocacy capacity at HQ level, a capacity that can be activated as soon as a crisis response is launched to systematically reach out to donor capitals, private sector actors and foundations to mobilize urgently needed resources. Previous AARs use the example of the private-sector emulated UNICEF machinery in this context.

54. The continuous involvement of authorities at CD level in activity planning and implementation is highly appreciated. In fact, not one single concern was raised by the different authorities in CD in terms of their involvement. Rather, they expressed their desire to see UNDP expand and scale up activities. Partnership building at provincial level therefore can be seen as exemplary and should accordingly be recognized as a best practice.

55. Regular technical and strategic engagement of authorities at national level is required. This point has been discussed earlier. Specifically, UNDP should engage involved ministries in the technical design as well as in strategic discussions with regards to the CD response. In addition, CO national staff felt that they could not use

their inroads into Ministries to advocate for UNDP's programme since they were not involved in stabilization-related questions. Whether this reflects the situation truthfully or not, UNDP CO management should not miss the opportunity to kindle technical and strategic buy-in at national level now that the project document is signed, supported wherever possible by international and national staff and their relationships.

56. **Communications around stabilization have been extremely timid and should be scaled up now that the prove of concept has been delivered.** It was explained that communication efforts were deliberately kept low-profile in view of the sensitive context. Yet, UNDP is actively communicating on various sensitive political contexts such as Yemen or Afghanistan. In the Mozambique case, it would have been helpful to showcase stabilization efforts to international partners and to provide additional visibility to national efforts. Certainly, this would have required the support of an experienced communication staff used to operate in politically sensitive environments. Strategic guidance and communication support from HQ/BERA would have also been helpful. The AAR could not clearly establish why this did not happen, especially since BERA COMS support in other crises such as Northern Nigeria has been exemplary. Irrespective, the recommendation is to ensure politically experienced guidance is provided to deployed communication staff so as to be able to design and evolve UNDP's storyline of the response.

57. **The landscape of technical relationships of UNDP with regards to CD interventions is as complex as can be expected.** HCT / UNCT sister agencies at Maputo level have mostly been challenging UNDP's stabilization approach raising concerns of an expected negative impact on the humanitarian response. These concerns can be safely seen as motivated to limit as much as possible UNDP competition in Cabo Delgado. At the same time, UNDP has established solid working relationships with the same agencies. In terms of practical collaboration, programmatic partnerships were established with UNFPA (with whom UNDP shares an office), UNODC and OCHCR. Relationships with the World Bank and its implementing partner, UNOPS, remain friendly but tense. This is especially due to indications from the Cabo Delgado authorities that parallel discussions between World Bank and Government on Stabilization might have played a role in the delayed signature of the UNDP stabilization project document. The ongoing partnership with SAMIM (SADC) has already been discussed earlier. Related recommendations are to (a) clarify UNDP's role in man-made conflict settings with corporate support, (b) to establish additional programmatic partnerships with select HCT/UNCT sister agencies including UNHCR (see above point 24) (c) to continue developing a practical working relationship with the WB and UNOPS revolving around coordination of interventions in Cabo Delgado and (d) to proactively pursue and evolve the partnership with SAMIM.

Textbox 2: Country-level recommendations

Recommendations:

14. **Local Coordination of Reconstruction and Recovery:** Pro-actively support the local PRCD & PREDIN coordination platform to drive coordination through technical and secretariat support.
15. **National Reconstruction and Recovery coordination:** Establish a working-level, technical coordination platform for stabilization involving key ministries, and explore support to the establishment of a national PREDIN-related partner coordination forum in collaboration with RCO.
16. **Partnerships with UN sister agencies:** Establish a strategic partnership with one or two suitable sister agencies including UNHCR to strengthen UNDP positioning with regards to durable solutions (return).
17. **UNDP's role:** Clearly define and communicate UNDP's new role, including stabilization, in man-made crisis response settings to sister agencies, OCHA and international partners.
18. **CO-SO integration:** Ensure regular presence of Cabo Delgado staff in Maputo and vice versa, including regular updates and presentations from the Head of Sub Office to Maputo-based colleagues.

19. **Needs assessments:** Complement the IDA with a pragmatic socio-economic and community perception survey to inform targeting and consolidate positioning.
20. **Scale and expand:** Expand stabilization activities to reach at least 20,000 CFW beneficiaries in 2023, while gradually scoping broader area-based programme interventions.
21. **CO capacities and workflows:** Conduct a light CO capacity and workflow review to avoid bottlenecks in 2023 during the scale-up.
22. **Donor coordination:** Establish a “Friends of UNDP” donor group on stabilization, also venturing into nexus territory.
23. **3rd party workforce:** Review and improve security arrangements and social security package of CTG staff jointly with CTG.
24. **Sub Office security measures:** Engage in a dialogue with sister agencies to re-evaluate risks and update the SRM. The option of a joint UN compound that would allow for improved blast mitigation should be considered if other measures can no longer lower the residual risk to acceptable levels.
25. **Sub Office Management structure:** Review the SO structural set-up, especially supervisory arrangements to enhance management coherence and efficiency.
26. **CO-SO integration:** Establish a formal, regular CO-SO exchange and ensure regular “staff exchanges” between CO and SO.
27. **Sub Office workflows and systems:** Define key sub office workflows and train staff.
28. **Strategic communications:** Seeking support from BERA, craft UNDP’s story in Cabo Delgado and showcase its interventions through more regular and more strategic communications.

5 Specific Considerations

5.1 Lessons for stabilization

The most important lesson to be learned with regards to the concept of stabilization is the confirmation that “stabilization”, i.e., the combination of immediate cash for work with subsequent public infrastructure, and community security interventions at speed and scale in areas most affected by the conflict as soon as they become accessible, is a meaningful and highly effective way for UNDP to engage early on in conflict contexts.

In northern Mozambique, UNDP’s positioning today is unprecedented thanks to the implementation of stabilization interventions in the most affected districts well before other humanitarian and development partners. This fact strongly supports the expansion and scaling of stabilization interventions in Cabo Delgado. Beyond Mozambique, it should serve as an argument for the organization to make stabilization a signature approach for early intervention in post-conflict situations.¹⁶

Stabilization allows for early engagement – much earlier than more complex “early” recovery interventions. It ensures full complementarity to humanitarian interventions of sister agencies and allows for the provision of meaningful support to deprived and highly conflict-affected communities without negatively impacting self-reliance and national ownership. Moreover, stabilization prepares the ground and positions UNDP to seamlessly follow through with longer-term recovery and community resilience interventions once stabilization objectives have been achieved.

The Mozambique Cabo Delgado response also illustrates that stabilization can attract significant donor funding at an early stage of the crisis. Funding sources used by donors are not humanitarian in nature. Therefore, stabilization interventions cannot be seen to reduce funding available for life saving.

¹⁶ This is valid as long as certain preconditions are given, including the ability of the government to provide sufficient protection for UNDP’s interventions.

There are, however, several organizational factors that need to be rapidly addressed if UNDP decides to make stabilization a signature approach in crisis. These are the establishment of:

- An adequate pool of vetted, experienced stabilization practitioners
- A dedicated organizational programme and operations support capacity
- A set of operational regulations and practices for fluid (volatile) environments

A key overall recommendation of the After-Action Review therefore is to address these three factors, possibly through the establishment of a dedicated cross-functional support team for stabilization.¹⁷

5.2 Lessons for complex crisis with displacement

The experience in northern Mozambique illustrates that a stabilization-focused approach is suitable – under certain circumstances – in displacement settings and that it allows for tangible engagement in the triple nexus. Since the approach aims to stabilize areas, it de facto prepares for one of the three durable solutions, namely return. This requires a close working relationship with UNHCR in line with the UNDP-UNHCR Global Partnership on Forced Displacement, especially to ensure adequate protection of returnees. In addition, it requires sequencing of activities and coordination with agencies supporting basic service provision following return. In other words, successful stabilization interventions prepare for the establishment of solution-oriented nexus coordination in displacement settings.

As such, an early engagement in displacement settings through stabilization interventions customized to local context and need not only prepares for subsequent, more comprehensive area-based recovery interventions. As expressed by donors in discussions during the AAR, it also constitutes a meaningful way to engage in the triple nexus. As discussed above this will, however, require a much more proactive engagement of UNDP to drive and possibly lead hands-on nexus coordination in these contexts and thereby fill the coordination vacuum detected in Mozambique and similar contexts.

The fact that UNDP was the first agency to engage in red zones and to start preparations for possible voluntary return also illustrates an engagement model that is significantly different from the traditional “humanitarians first, followed by recovery when the time is right” approach. This is probably one of the most exciting conclusions from the Cabo Delgado AAR. As shown in Mozambique, it is time for UNDP to unapologetically redefine its image, mandate, and approach in man-made crises involving displacement.

5.3 Application of lessons from earlier AARs

With regards to the extent to which key recommendations of previous AARs have been implemented during the Cabo Delgado response, reference is made to a review of AARs commissioned by the Crisis Bureau in 2020. The below table which stems from this review provides an overview of recurrent recommendations, to which the present AAR has added comments either relating the recommendation to the Mozambican context or to recent Crisis Bureau efforts.¹⁸ The brief review shows that 11 out of 27 (40%) of key AAR recommendations have been addressed, as experienced in the Cabo Delgado context. However, there is only little progress with regards to the most recurrent (priority) recommendations; notably only on 3 out of 8 of these.

¹⁷ The corporate UNDP Global Fund Support Team established in 2006 serves as an example how such a team can be established and funded. It also illustrates how a central support capacity supported and ensured the successful management of large country-based portfolios in over 20 countries.

¹⁸ UNDP Crisis Bureau (2020): “Responding to Crisis in the new Decade: Revamping UNDP’s crisis response capacities based on lessons learned and anticipated trends”.

Progress has been made with regards to contract modalities that are appropriate for deployment in crisis settings. While still not ideal, the IPSA / NPSA modality comes with an adequate insurance package and the required flexibility and therefore is preferable over the IC modality.

Significant experimentation with different approaches to surge planning and the sequencing of surge support has taken place since 2020. The different approaches used inter alia in Mozambique, Ethiopia, Ukraine and Afghanistan provide a good range of possibilities. While it is recognized that each context requires adaptations to a standard approach, it is now time to draw the lessons from these experiences and redefine surge planning and sequencing of support as part of the new Crisis Response SOPs.

The surge planning methodology seems to also have embraced elements of scenario planning, as can be seen in the Cabo Delgado strategic and operational plan. This methodology, however, has only been partially applied in Mozambique since it did not go as far as to design a scenario-based priority action plan. This is something to consider for a future response.

Significant progress has been made with regards to UNDP signature assessment methodologies informing response planning. The IDA used in Mozambique is an outstanding example. However, it will be critical to include socio-economic and social coherence aspects into future crisis-related assessments. As explained earlier, the SEIA methodology developed and applied by the Surge Data Hub during the Covid-19 crisis might be helpful in this context.

5 critical missed opportunities to act on earlier AAR recommendations have been identified during the Cabo Delgado AAR. First, there was no continuity of follow-up and support after Crisis Board approval of the surge plan and allocation of resources. The fact that follow-up CMSTs and the 3rd CB never convened illustrates this finding.

Second, CO capacities were not holistically reviewed as part of the surge planning effort as discussed above under point 46, which led to capacity bottlenecks during response implementation.

Third, OAI's approach to conducting CO audits continuously disincentivizes informed risk-taking, as illustrated by the audit of the Mozambique CO conducted in November 2021. It therefore contributes to an organizational environment that rewards inaction and overly cautions approaches rather than effective crisis leadership. As expressed by Yemen colleagues involved in the Hodeidah response (and quoted from the Hodeidah AAR):

"Careers of operations managers in UNDP have failed because of a perceived inappropriate use of procedures, but no career has failed because of a lack of efficiency of an operations manager during a crisis response"

Fourth, UNDP Central Bureaus have not yet managed to reorganize in such a way that they can provide mandate-related hands-on support to the implementation of a response. This refers to strategic communications (BERA), resources mobilization (BERA), procurement and finance systems (BMS) and continuous programmatic support (CB/ BPPS). It is encouraging to hear in this context, however, that the BMS organizational performance team is currently assessing the possibility to designing operational rules and regulations for fluid environments.

Finally, UNDP has not yet managed to unpack the Nexus concept so as to provide practical guidance to country offices. Beyond concepts, this should clearly guide country offices on how establish, drive and support Nexus

coordination groups. It could possibly also mean the establishment of a pool of Nexus coordination advisors who can be deployed to crises upon RR request.

Table 3: Recurrent AAR recommendations of the past 8 years and their application in Cabo Delgado

Recommendation	Priority	Progress	Details
Complex Environments			
Crisis insurance package for consultants	3	Yes	With introduction of IPSA / NPSA modality, basic insurance coverage is provided.
Remote management / sub office guidance	6	No	The existing guidance has not been updated since 2010. No specific guidance for surge teams available.
Crisis package for protracted and complex	3	Yes	Under development, as part of the new CB offer.
Rapid Response teams	4	No	Not established. In Mozambique, a RRT would have been useful to kick-start stabilization.
Scenario planning and preparedness	7	Yes	Was used for surge planning in Mozambique, but needs to be further strengthened to define key actions for each scenario.
Investing in People			
Inner Circle consultants (training, preclearance ...)	7	No	No progress.
Dedicated Operations Surge effort (incl. security)	7	No	No progress as it refers to the Mozambique response, even though the Surge Delivery Lab has been established and could have possibly been engaged.
Expanded surge training (incl. soft skills)	5	Yes	Has been implemented by the Surge academy.
Professionalize Deployment Briefings and Debriefings	5	No	Has not happened in the Mozambique context.
Mentorship and counseling	4	No	No progress, as far as the author is aware.
Harness organizational Surge culture	4	Yes	Significant progress in the context of the Surge academy.
CO Management training (RR / DRR)	4	No	No progress, as far as the author is aware.
Positioning the brand			
UNDP role and vision / Brand	6	Yes	Good progress, with the new CB offer. But not yet well profiled and understood among donors.
Practical NEXUS guidance	3	No	What currently exists, is not useful. Something much more practical is needed.
Clarify Early Recovery Cluster and Role	3	No	Big gap.
Strengthen Crisis Communications	7	No	No progress, as far as the author is aware. In the case of Mozambique, stronger corporate support would have been beneficial.
Professionalize resource mobilization (HQ machinery)	6	No	No progress, as far as the author is aware.
Response Architecture			
Crisis Bureau Capacities for crisis management	4	Yes	Good progress, at CSMT level.
Assessment of CO capacities / leadership configuration	5	No	No progress, as far as the author is aware. In the Mozambique case, this did not happen.
Field-based surge coordination	5	Yes	Was applied, among others in Mozambique.
Revamp Crisis Board for decision-making and risk mgmt	4	No	No progress, as far as the author is aware. However, in the Mozambique case the CB was well used for decision-making.
Single Corporate Bureau Coordination	3	No	No progress, as far as the author is aware.
Expanded surge period (3+6 / 1y)	5	Yes	Applied in the Mozambique case.
Systems, Processes & Tools			
Assessment system	7	Yes	Some good progress with the introduction of the SEIA and HBDA. This now needs to be further developed to become a crisis signature approach.
Fast-Track 2.0	5	No	No progress, as far as the author is aware.
Revolving funding instrument	3	No	No progress, as far as the author is aware.

Review surge planning approach	1	Yes	Experimentation ongoing (Afghanistan, Ethiopia, Mozambique). Lessons now need to be captured in updated SOPs.
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6 Prioritizing Recommendations & Action Plan

The 28 recommendations proposed by the AAR have different levels of impact, urgency, feasibility and costs. These four factors have been considered to propose prioritization and sequencing of implementation (see annex 7.5 and 7.6 as well as the separate Excel workbook).

Prioritization has been based on (1) the possible impact and (2) the urgency of each recommendation.¹⁹ It is proposed critical and high priority recommendations will be implemented immediately (within the next 6 months). Medium and low priority recommendations should be assessed regarding their costs and feasibility and possibly implemented during the following 6 months.

Feasibility and costs have been used to identify “low-hanging fruits”, i.e. recommendations that can be easily implemented and do not have a significant cost while promising a reasonable level of impact.²⁰ It is proposed that recommendations with medium impact and low costs will also be implemented during the next 6 months.

The following **corporate priority recommendations** were identified and are proposed for immediate implementation:

- **Stabilization as core crisis offer:** Integrate stabilization as a core element into the UNDP crisis response offer, including the design of a default stabilization package, conceptional clarity on the link between stabilization and the triple nexus, the establishment of a corporate support team, and pro-active corporate communication of this offer to partners and donors.
- **Advisor pools:** Actively develop a pool of experienced of stabilization practitioners (programme & operations) as well as of Heads of Sub Office.
- **UNDP’s needs assessment methodology:** Build in the IDA and SEIA to develop a holistic albeit practical UNDP needs assessment methodology for crisis settings, i.e., integrate infrastructure damage, socio-economic impact and social coherence / security aspects.
- **Pro-active resources mobilization:** Establish a corporate capacity that provides hands-on advocacy and resources mobilization support to L2 and L3 crises.
- **Crisis Praxis Experiences:** Expand crisis academy activities to include 3-6 months “practice experiences” for academy graduates.

The following **country-level priority recommendations** were identified and are proposed for immediate implementation:

- **CO capacities and workflows:** Conduct a light CO capacity and workflow review to avoid bottlenecks in 2023 during the scale-up.
- **Donor coordination:** Establish a “Friends of UNDP” donor group on stabilization, also venturing into nexus territory.
- **National Reconstruction and Recovery coordination:** Establish a working-level, technical coordination platform for stabilization involving key ministries, and explore support to the establishment of a national PRCD & PREDIN-related partner coordination forum in collaboration with RCO.

¹⁹ Impact is defined as the degree to which the implementation of the recommendation will strengthen UNDPs crisis response worldwide, for corporate recommendations, and the degree to which the implementation will strengthen UNDPs current and future response in Mozambique, for CO recommendations. Urgency is defined as the degree to which the recommendation needs to be implemented immediately to have the required impact and / or to prevent risks associated with not implementing the recommendation.

²⁰ Feasibility is defined as the degree to which the implementation of a recommendation does or does not require complex technical work and lengthy coordination processes. Costs were assessed as implementable without an additional allocation of resources (rated as 1), with a modest allocation of additional resources (rated as 2-3), and with a significant allocation of additional resources (rated as 4-5).

- **Sub Office Management structure:** Review the SO structural set-up, especially supervisory arrangements to enhance management coherence and efficiency.
- **Sub Office workflows and systems:** Define key sub office workflows and train staff.
- **Sub Office security measures:** Engage in a dialogue with sister agencies to re-evaluate risks and update the SRM. The option of a joint UN compound that would allow for improved blast mitigation should be considered if other measures can no longer lower the residual risk to acceptable levels.
- **Partnerships with UN sister agencies:** Establish a strategic partnership with one or two suitable sister agencies including UNHCR to strengthen UNDP positioning with regards to durable solutions (return).
- **3rd party workforce:** Review and improve security arrangements and social security package of CTG staff jointly with CTG.
- **UNDP's role:** Clearly define and communicate UNDP's new role, including stabilization, in man-made crisis response settings to sister agencies, OCHA and international partners.

In addition, the following corporate and country-level **“low-hanging fruit” recommendations** have been identified:

- **Strategic communications:** Standardize the BERA strategic communications offer for L2 and L3 crises and provide dedicated communications training to surge advisors and inner-circle consultants with a communication profile.
- **Deployment preparation:** Systematically conduct pre-assignment briefings to advisors and consultants.
- **Surge Planning:** Evolve surge planning to consist of (1) a light programmatic visioning process, (2) scenario planning, and (3) the assessment of workflows, CO main team capacities and capacity gap identification.
- **CO-SO integration:** Establish a formal, regular CO-SO exchange and ensure regular “staff exchanges” between CO and SO.

Please refer to annex 7.6 and 7.7 for the full list of recommendations.

7 Annexes

7.1 Analytical Framework

Table 4: Corporate level areas of inquiry and key aspects to be reviewed

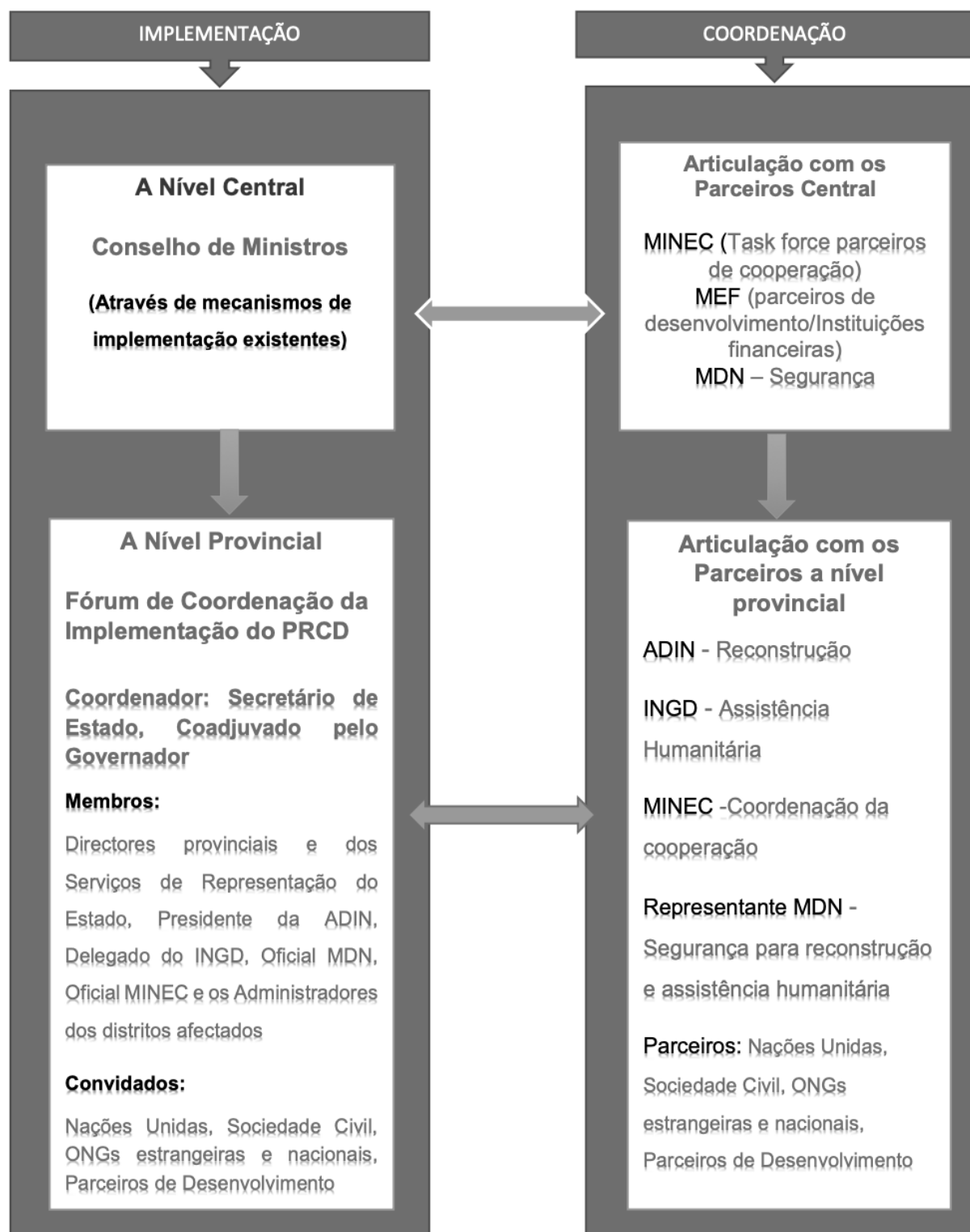
Area of inquiry	Key aspects to be assessed
Corporate Response Strategy & Coordination	- Provision of overall vision and guidance for Cabo Delgado response - Corporate prioritization and decision-making in addressing Mozambique requirements - Response oversight & management, including timeliness and effectiveness of decision-making - Corporate senior-level engagement in critical internal and external communication
Corporate Response Mechanisms	- Application of the UNDP Crisis Response SOPs (compliance) in Mozambique - Surge Planning Process - Relevance and use of Crisis Response Packages - Effectiveness of mainstreamed fast track procedures - Availability and use of funding / investment support - Preparedness (procurement, deployments, funding)
Deployments	- Availability of crisis-related expertise to support the Mozambique response (external, internal): quality, speed, performance - Adequacy of contractual modalities - Use and relevance of the Express roster - Use and Effectiveness of stand-by partners - Transfer of knowledge for post-surge period - Deployment innovations
Deployment Support: individual & team	- Adequacy of selected profiles to operate in crisis environment - Preparation of deployments for crisis environment - Support to well-being of individual deployments during deployment - Facilitation of CO team – Surge team dynamics during response including collaboration with and ownership from CO staff (national and international)
HQ Implementation Support in a level 2 context (Mozambique)	- HQ support to CO crisis programming - HQ support to CO crisis operations management - HQ support to RM and Communications - Existing and potential new support to CO beyond 6-month crisis package (especially to former L2)

Table 5: Country level areas of inquiry and key aspects to be reviewed

Area of inquiry	Key aspects to be assessed
Local Crisis Coordination	UNDP's support to: - UN coordination, including Nexus coordination - Donor coordination - Developing Government Crisis coordination capacities
Country Office Response Structure and Capacities	- CO management vision and guidance - Management & leadership structure of crisis response

	▪ Dedicated crisis response capacities (prog / ops) provided ▪ Additional workload impact on the Country Office ▪ Integration of surge response into CO structures / establishment of linkages
Sub Office and Remote Management Structure	▪ Relevance of the business case ▪ Effectiveness of the sub office, as compared to business case targets ▪ SO-CO relationship and interaction (Programme, Operations, Communication, Representation) ▪ Cross-unit collaboration (COMS-PROG-M&E, PROG-COM-RM, COORD-COM-RM, Partnerships-OPS, PROG-OPS) ▪ SO structure and management
Programmatic Response	▪ Programmatic positioning strategy and offer ▪ Programmatic partnerships ▪ Use and re-direction of existing programme and funding streams ▪ Level and type/modality of funding made available through CO / HQ (incl. revolving fund) ▪ Programmatic sustainability (continuous relevance, funding) and results achievement ▪ Programme Innovations (substantive, procedural, ...), especially with regards to the implementation of the stabilization approach
Operational Response	▪ Procurement ▪ Resources management ▪ Operational Partnerships ▪ Financial and Cash management ▪ Recruitments / sourcing of talent and expertise, and efficient processing of recruitments ▪ Security: mechanism and processes used for deployments in the highly insecure environment ▪ Operational Innovations (including cash management)
Communication	▪ Communication strategy ▪ Communication Products ▪ Outreach and media / external presence, and platforms, vehicles, channels used ▪ Coordination between CO regular communication function and crisis coordination ▪ Internal communication of vision, goals, targets and facilitation of cross-unit communication
Partnerships and Resource Mobilization	▪ RM strategy, approach, and outreach (products, platforms, channels used) ▪ RM partnerships ▪ RM results – level of mobilization overall and against target ▪ National and international partner's perception to the UNDP response ▪ Partnership innovations

7.2 PRCD Governance and Coordination Structure



7.3 Key recommendations from the Mozambique Resident Representative

The below recommendations were developed by the UNDP Resident Representative in Mozambique as inputs into the Stabilization Workshop in Dakar in November 2022. They have informed the AAR and its recommendations.

For UNDP to establish its niche in stabilization, building on the experience of Mozambique, the following require specific engagement, narrative, and investment:

Anchor stabilization more firmly within the UNDP mandate, as a required and determining contribution to the Prevention agenda of the SG and international community: over the last decade, and even in those countries where overall ODA numbers increased (which is the case for Mozambique), the percentage of ODA supporting core governance functions has decreased substantially. The 2019 numbers place it at around 4.2% of total ODA funding in fragile countries, while most indicators have steadily shown a sharp increase in fragility over the past decade. **What this basically means is that the support provided to the capacities of the State to manage or direct development and peace has steadily decreased, making the realistic implementation of a prevention agenda unlikely.** Building and sustaining Peace is about Nation building and therefore State building. At the core of this is the construction and maintenance of the social contract, and **the UNDP narrative to donors, partners, and other agencies needs to be stronger in ensuring understanding of the fact that stabilization rests at the heart of the UNDP mandate**, fundamentally linked to its integrator role.

Having said that, **UNDP needs to explicitly recognize and work to off set the very high reputational risk entailed by stabilization programming.** The risk is indeed high of being associated to maintaining or restoring an inadequate social contract, one that was at the origin of the conflict in the first place. For this reason, it is critical to ensure that the **Regional Bureau and wider Organization's political backup to the CO is guaranteed**, well beyond whatever support the RC can provide. It is also critical that **national capacities for civil-military coordination be strengthened**, not in the traditional sense of facilitating access, but rather in the sense of stakeholders across the civil-military spectrum fully understanding and owning their respective responsibilities in rebuilding the social contract.

Because speed and scale are fundamental to the credibility and legitimacy of stabilization engagement, it is paramount for **critical masses of investments to be made available quickly to COs** in order to develop proof of concept, clearly show peace dividends to the population, and make it easier to sustainably negotiate the space with authorities towards real appropriation by them of the fundamentals of a new social contract. In this regard, for the Organization to position adequately, the **setup of a regional/global facility or the rigorous and systematic use of existing TF** should be looked into to support the mobilization of donor resources. Whatever facility should **keep country specificities and windows while possibly enabling more cross-border or event regional elements to articulate coherently as a full package** (these could include political engagement with regional / sub-regional institutions in addition to some cross-border initiatives).

From a more operational point of view, it is critical for other programming components to be added to a stabilization intervention – and clearly this depends greatly on the context – including public administration/institutional reform, justice and security sector reform, and wider peace building/political solution programmes, as stabilization in and of itself is none of those. In this regard and in addition, **stronger HDP expertise should be included from the start**, one going beyond the existing HDP Nexus one UNDP currently deploys, making it possible to adequately link stabilization work with durable solutions, IDP management and wider SDG planning, in line with the conclusions of the UNSG HLP report on displacement.

Strengthening some of the critical capacities needed: although some of the pillars of stabilization programming can draw on existing well established UNDP capacities, critical sets of skills are not readily available and if the organization is to establish its niche, it is required to quickly beef up on that front. **Two critical ones are related**

to infrastructure work (it remains very difficult to find good engineers, also capable of comprehending the wider UNDP mandate and engagement) and to procurement (we still are not capable to mobilize very quickly the needed procurement expertise, in country or remotely, to support speed and scale ambitions. **If the Organization is to seriously strengthen its engagement and scale up**, a specific team also needs to be in place in HQ to support procurement related processes, fast track those processes, and **support procurement teams on the ground to find solutions to operating in high risk, difficult contexts where private sector operators often do not have proper capacities** to meet UNDP standards.

7.4 AAR Interviewees

Name	Title / Function / Office	Link to CD Response
National Counterparts		
Valige Tauabo	Governor of Cabo Delgado	CD Strategic Lead
Armindo Ngunga	President, ADIB	UNDP Cabo Delgado Focal Point
District Administrators	District Administration	District Focal Points
International Partners		
Professor Mpho G. Molomo	Head of SAMIM (SADC) Mission	Key UNDP Partner
Ingmar Kreisl	1 st Secretary, German Embassy	Cabo Delgado Focal Point
Riccardo ROSSI	Stabilization Focal Point, EU	Cabo Delgado Focal Point
Paula VAZQUEZ HORYAANS	Head of Cooperation, EU	EU Strategic Lead
Matthew Sumpter	USAID	Cabo Delgado Focal Point
Annelies Mudde	Head of Cooperation, Netherlands	Cabo Delgado Focal Point
UNDP CB and RB Leadership		
Noura Hamladji	Deputy Regional Director, RBA	Regional Bureau Strategic Lead
Janthomas Hiemstra	CB CSMT Team Leader	Surge Lead
RB and CB Focal Points for the AAR		
Owen Shumba	Regional Advisor, RBA	Regional Bureau Focal Point
Christina Hackmann	CSMT Programme Specialist	CB CSMT Focal Point
UNDP Surge Advisors / Deployments		
Aboubacar Koulibaly	Surge Team Leader	Surge Advisor, wave 1
Hyewon Yung	Stabilization Advisor	Surge Advisor, wave 1
Yacin Kouadio Komenan	Operations Advisor	Surge Advisor, wave 1
Claudia Fernandes	Communications Advisor	Surge Advisor, wave 1
Christian Friedrichs	Security Advisor	Surge Advisor, wave 1
Mohammed Abu Shaaban	Civil Engineer Specialist	Surge Advisor, wave 2
Hanan Al Ali	Procurement Advisor	Surge Advisor, wave 2
Stephen Kinloch Pichat	Head of Sub-Office	Surge Advisor, wave 2
Craig Castro	Head of Sub Office	Surge Advisor, wave 2
Florian Morier	Stabilization Project Manager	Surge Advisor, wave 2
Roselyne Sinemani	Operations Advisor	Surge Advisor, wave 2
UNDP Country Office		
Narjess Saidane	RR	CO Strategic Lead
Anna Chyzhkova	DRR/O	CO Operations Lead
Florian Morier	Pemba HoS a.i.	Cabo Delgado Lead
Roseline Sinemani	Pemba OM	Cabo Delgado Operations Lead
Olivia Pereira	RM Specialist	Post-surge RM lead
United Nations Coordination		

Carlos Dinis	Head of RCO	UN Coordination Technical Lead
Niall Tierney	RCO Planning Specialist	Cabo Delgado Focal Point

7.5 AAR Focus Group Discussions

Team	Topic	Location
CO Operations Team	Operational requirements and challenges of the response	Maputo
CO Programme Team	Programmatic requirements and challenges of the response	Maputo
Sub Office Team	Current concerns and future opportunities in Cabo Delgado	Pemba
UN HCT in Pemba	Role of the HCT and UNDP's response	Pemba
CD District Administrators	Response planning and national ownership	